COMPLETE STAFF WORK GUIDEBOOK FOR THE BANGSAMORO AUTONOMOUS REGION

A Practical Guide for Parliament Staff,
Ministry Personnel, and Government Officers

THE ADDRESS IT FRAMEWORK

Saidamen R. Mambayao

BANGSAMORO GOVERNMENT

BANGSAMORO AUTONOMOUS REGION IN MUSLIM MINDANAO

Bangsamoro Government Center, Cotabato City

Table of Contents

Introduction

How to Use This Guidebook
The ADDRESS IT Framework at a Glance

Chapter 1 — The Philosophy of Complete Staff Work

1.1 What CSW Means in Practice
- 1.1.1 The Decision-Maker Should Only Need to Approve or Disapprove
- 1.1.2 CSW as Professional Discipline, Not Bureaucratic Burden

1.2 CSW in the Philippine Public Service Tradition
- 1.2.1 MC No. 72/2019 and MC No. 2/2022
- 1.2.2 Adaptation for Bangsamoro Autonomous Governance

1.3 Why CSW Matters for the Bangsamoro People

Chapter 2 — CSW in the Bangsamoro Context

2.1 The Bangsamoro Governance Structure
- 2.1.1 Parliament (BTA) and Its Legislative Functions
- 2.1.2 Ministries, Offices, and Agencies (MOAs)
- 2.1.3 Local Government Units Under BARMM

2.2 How CSW Serves Both Legislative and Executive Functions
2.3 The Legal Framework: BOL, BAA 13, and Moral Governance
2.4 The Bangsamoro Development Plan and CSW Alignment

Chapter 3 — Types of CSW in BARMM

3.1 Overview: The CSW Type Table
3.2 Legislative Analysis Briefer (LA) — The 13-Section Format
3.3 Budget Briefer (BB) — The BB-Coded Template
3.4 Policy Recommendation (PR) — Bardach's Eightfold Path
3.5 Legal Opinion (LO)
3.6 Project Proposal (PP)
3.7 Personnel/Administrative Action (PA)
3.8 Supervision System (SV)
3.9 General CSW (GN) — The Universal Template
3.10 When to Use Which Type

Chapter 4 — Step 1: Analyze the Context (A)

4.1 Understanding the Assignment
- 4.1.1 Clarifying Purpose, Objectives, and Desired Outcomes
- 4.1.2 When the Assignment Is Unclear

4.2 Assessing Your Office's Function and Your Role
4.3 Identifying Stakeholders (Primary and Secondary)
4.4 Examining Internal and External Factors
- 4.4.1 PESTEL Analysis for BARMM Context

4.5 Reviewing Relevant Laws, Policies, and Regulations
- 4.5.1 BOL Provisions
- 4.5.2 Relevant BAAs
- 4.5.3 National Laws and IRRs

4.6 Gathering Preliminary Data
4.7 Why This Step Matters — Consequences of Skipping

Chapter 5 — Step 2: Define and Deliberate the Problem or Need (DD)

5.1 Articulating the Problem Statement
- 5.1.1 Specific, Measurable, and Aligned
- 5.1.2 The Problem Statement Template

5.2 Engaging Stakeholders in Deliberation
5.3 Root Cause Analysis
- 5.3.1 The 5 Whys Method
- 5.3.2 Fishbone (Ishikawa) Diagram

5.4 Assessing Consequences of Inaction
5.5 Establishing SMART Objectives
5.6 Documenting the Problem Statement
5.7 Why This Step Matters — Consequences of Skipping

Chapter 6 — Step 3: Research Needed Information (R)

6.1 Developing a Research Plan
6.2 Identifying and Evaluating Sources
- 6.2.1 Government Data (PSA-BARMM, MFBM, Implementing Agencies)
- 6.2.2 Academic and Policy Research
- 6.2.3 Stakeholder Inputs

6.3 Conducting a Literature Review
6.4 Gathering Primary Data
- 6.4.1 Surveys, Interviews, Focus Groups
- 6.4.2 Ethical Guidelines and Data Privacy

6.5 Analyzing and Synthesizing Information

6.6 Identifying Best Practices
6.7 Documenting and Validating Findings
6.8 Why This Step Matters — Consequences of Skipping

Chapter 7 — Step 4: Explore Options (E)

7.1 Generating Options (Minimum 2-3)
7.2 Evaluation Criteria
- 7.2.1 Feasibility
- 7.2.2 Effectiveness
- 7.2.3 Efficiency
- 7.2.4 Sustainability
- 7.2.5 Alignment with Organizational Goals

7.3 Impact Analysis
7.4 Cost-Benefit Analysis
7.5 Prioritizing and Ranking Options
7.6 Validating with Stakeholders
7.7 Preparing for Recommendation
7.8 Why This Step Matters — Consequences of Skipping

Chapter 8 — Step 5: Submit Proposal or Report (SS)

8.1 Developing the Report Structure
8.2 Writing the Executive Summary (Write Last)
8.3 Presenting the Problem and Research Findings
8.4 Discussing Options Explored
8.5 Presenting the Recommendation
8.6 Developing the Implementation Plan
8.7 The Call to Action
8.8 Review and Refinement
8.9 Obtaining Supervisor Review and Clearance
8.10 Submitting to the Decision-Maker
8.11 The Transmittal Memorandum
8.12 Why This Step Matters — Consequences of Skipping

Chapter 9 — Step 6: Sustain Efforts to Implement (S)

9.1 Keeping Approval and Stakeholder Support
9.2 Mobilizing Resources
9.3 Developing Detailed Action Plans
9.4 Training and Capacity Building
9.5 Monitoring Progress

9.6 Engaging Stakeholders Throughout Implementation
9.7 Why This Step Matters — Consequences of Skipping

Chapter 10 — Step 7: Iterate and Improve (IT)

10.1 Monitoring and Evaluation Framework
10.2 Collecting Feedback
10.3 Analyzing Performance Data
10.4 Identifying Areas for Improvement
10.5 Iterating and Refining
10.6 Documenting Lessons Learned
10.7 Restarting the CSW Cycle When Necessary
10.8 Why This Step Matters — Consequences of Skipping

Chapter 11 — CSW for Parliamentary Committees

11.1 How the 13-Section Legislative Briefer Maps to ADDRESS IT
11.2 Committee-Specific CSW
11.3 Committee Reports and Oversight CSW
11.4 Interpellation Preparation as CSW
11.5 Budget Deliberation Briefers

Chapter 12 — CSW for MOA Decision-Making

12.1 Budget Requests and Financial Proposals
12.2 Project Proposals and Program Design
12.3 Personnel Actions and Administrative Matters
12.4 Procurement Justifications
12.5 Approval Hierarchies and Transmittal Procedures
12.6 Working with COA Requirements

Chapter 13 — Writing Standards and Quality Assurance

13.1 The BARMM Guidebook Voice
13.2 Clarity, Completeness, Conciseness, Objectivity
13.3 The "So What" Test
13.4 Peer Review Process
13.5 Shari'ah and Gender Review
13.6 The Transmittal Memorandum as Quality Gate

Chapter 14 — Building a CSW Culture

14.1 The 12 ACSCCRaPATFEE Competencies

14.2 Training Staff in ADDRESS IT
14.3 Institutionalizing CSW Practices
14.4 Continuous Improvement as Organizational Habit
14.5 The Supervisor's Role in CSW Quality

Glossary of CSW Terms

Appendices

A. ADDRESS IT Quick Reference Card (Detachable)
B. Universal CSW Template — Parliament Context (Annotated)
C. Universal CSW Template — MOA Context (Annotated)
D. 13-Section Legislative Briefer Template (Annotated, mapped to ADDRESS IT)
E. Budget Briefer Template (BB01-BB13, Annotated)
F. CSW Quality Review Checklist (Detachable)
G. Stakeholder Analysis Template
H. Cost-Benefit Analysis Template
I. Transmittal Memorandum Template
J. ACSCCRaPATFEE Competency Assessment Tool (7-Level, 42 Questions)
K. Sample CSW Documents (3 examples: legislative briefer, policy recommendation, budget proposal — annotated with ADDRESS IT step labels)

About This Guidebook

Purpose

This guidebook provides a comprehensive, practical framework for Complete Staff Work (CSW) within the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM). It translates the principles of CSW — as mandated by Memorandum Circular No. 72, s. 2019 and MC No. 2, s. 2022 — into actionable guidance tailored for Bangsamoro governance.

The guidebook introduces the **ADDRESS IT** framework, a seven-step methodology that structures the CSW process from initial analysis through implementation and continuous improvement:

Step	Mnemonic	Action
1	**A**	Analyze the Context
2	**DD**	Define and Deliberate the Problem or Need
3	**R**	Research Needed Information
4	**E**	Explore Options
5	**SS**	Submit Proposal or Report
6	**S**	Sustain Efforts to Implement
7	**IT**	Iterate and Improve

Intended Audience

This guidebook is written for three primary audiences:

1. **Parliament Staff** — Committee secretariat members, legislative analysts, and research officers who prepare briefers, reports, and recommendations for Members of Parliament

2. **Ministry Personnel** — Staff of Ministries, Offices, and Agencies (MOAs) who prepare proposals, budget requests, project designs, and administrative actions for decision-makers
3. **Government Officers** — Supervisors, directors, and senior staff who review, approve, and champion CSW practices within their organizations

The material is designed for professionals at all experience levels, from newly hired staff learning CSW for the first time to seasoned officers seeking to formalize and improve their existing practices.

How to Use This Guidebook

For New Staff

Start with **Chapter 1** (Philosophy) and **Chapter 2** (Bangsamoro Context) to understand why CSW matters. Then read **Chapter 3** to identify which CSW type applies to your work. Follow with **Chapters 4-10** to learn the ADDRESS IT steps sequentially.

For Experienced Staff

Use **Chapter 3** to identify your CSW type, then jump to the relevant ADDRESS IT step chapters (4-10) as needed. Refer to **Chapters 11-12** for context-specific guidance (Parliament or MOA). Use the appendix templates to structure your outputs.

For Supervisors and Reviewers

Focus on **Chapter 13** (Writing Standards and Quality Assurance) and **Chapter 14** (Building a CSW Culture). Use **Appendix F** (Quality Review Checklist) and **Appendix J** (Competency Assessment Tool) to evaluate staff work and develop capacity.

For Training Facilitators

Each ADDRESS IT step chapter (4-10) includes a "Why This Step Matters — Consequences of Skipping" section that can be used as discussion material. The appendices provide ready-to-use templates for workshops and exercises. **Appendix K** offers annotated sample documents for classroom analysis.

Quick Reference

Appendix A (ADDRESS IT Quick Reference Card) is designed to be detached and kept at your desk as a daily reference. **Appendix F** (Quality Review Checklist) serves the same purpose for reviewers.

Conventions Used in This Guidebook

- **Bold text** highlights key terms, framework names, and important concepts

- *Italic text* indicates document titles, template names, and technical terms on first use
- Boxed callouts marked **TIP** provide practical advice from experienced practitioners
- Boxed callouts marked **CAUTION** warn about common mistakes and their consequences
- Boxed callouts marked **BANGSAMORO NOTE** highlight adaptations specific to BARMM governance
- Section references use the format "Chapter X, Section X.X" for cross-referencing
- All templates in the appendices include annotations explaining each field's purpose and how it maps to the ADDRESS IT framework

Relationship to Other BARMM Guidebooks

This CSW Guidebook complements the **Bill Drafting Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Parliament**, which provides detailed guidance on legislative drafting. Where the Bill Drafting Guidebook focuses on the technical craft of writing legislation, this guidebook covers the analytical and decision-support work that precedes, accompanies, and follows legislative action.

Staff preparing legislative briefers should use both guidebooks together: this guidebook for the CSW process and analytical framework, and the Bill Drafting Guidebook for drafting conventions and legal formatting standards.

About the Author

Saidamen "Sayeed" R. Mambayao has worked in governance, legislation, and cooperative development across the Bangsamoro region for over a decade.

Before the establishment of the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region, he served as a Consultant of the Cooperative Development Authority under the former Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao, where he led programs on cooperative development, Islamic finance, and executive leadership. He also served as Secretariat Head and Program Director of the Bangsamoro Executives and Leaders League (BELL), Inc., and held leadership roles in the ARMM Islamic Finance Sub-Cluster and the Bangsamoro Coalition on Social Enterprise.

When the Bangsamoro Transition Authority was established in 2019, he led the development and implementation of two BARMM flagship programs: the Access to Higher and Modern Education (AHME) Scholarship Program under the Ministry of Basic, Higher, and Technical Education, and the Engaging the SK, Empowering the Youth (ESKEY) Program under the Ministry of the Interior and Local Government. He later served as Chief of Staff at the Office of a Member of Parliament, where he assisted on legislative portfolios covering women, youth, children, persons with disabilities, cooperatives, social enterprises, and halal industries. He drafted and reviewed legislative measures on scholarships, cultural heritage preservation, assistance to Other Bangsamoro Communities, and cooperative and social enterprise development. He also served as OIC-Legislative Affairs at the Office of MP Sittie Fahanie S. Uy-Oyod.

He is the Founder of MoroTech and MoroAcademy, social enterprises empowering Bangsamoro organizations and communities through knowledge and technology, and the Founding Chairperson of the Bangsamoro Scholars Association. He also founded the SEED Initiative, a consultancy and training firm focused on cooperative and social enterprise development. He is an Active Citizen and graduate of the British Council's CSO-SEED Business and Investment Readiness Program.

Introduction

Your decision-maker just assigned you a task. You have a week. The output must be something they can approve or disapprove without rewriting your work. Where do you start?

This guidebook answers that question. It gives you a structured, repeatable process for producing **Complete Staff Work** (CSW) in the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region. Whether you draft legislative briefers in Parliament, prepare budget requests in a ministry, or write project proposals in an LGU, the process is the same.

The Problem This Guidebook Solves

Most government staff know *what* to produce. Few know *how* to get there systematically. Without a process, you waste time guessing what your supervisor wants. You miss stakeholders. You skip research. You present one option when three existed. You submit work that comes back covered in red ink.

CSW is the discipline that eliminates this waste. When done right, your superior should only need to do one thing: **approve or disapprove**.

What You Will Find Inside

This guidebook has four parts:

Part I: Foundations (Chapters 1-3) explains the philosophy of CSW, its place in Bangsamoro governance, and the nine types of CSW documents you will encounter.

Part II: The ADDRESS IT Process (Chapters 4-10) walks you through the seven steps of the ADDRESS IT framework, from analyzing the context to iterating on your solution. Each chapter covers one step with practical tools, templates, and BARMM examples.

Part III: Applications (Chapters 11-12) applies the ADDRESS IT framework to two specific contexts: Parliamentary committee work and Ministry/Office/Agency (MOA) decision-making.

Part IV: Quality and Culture (Chapters 13-14) covers writing standards, quality assurance, and how to build CSW as an institutional practice rather than a one-time training exercise.

The **Glossary** defines key terms. The **Appendices** provide detachable reference cards, templates, checklists, and sample documents.

The ADDRESS IT Framework at a Glance

ADDRESS IT is a seven-step methodology for Complete Staff Work. Each step builds on the one before it. The process is cyclical: Step 7 loops back to Step 1 when conditions change.

Step	Mnemonic	Action	Key Question
1	**A**	Analyze the Context	What is the assignment, who are the stakeholders, and what laws apply?
2	**DD**	Define and Deliberate the Problem or Need	What exactly is the problem, and what causes it?
3	**R**	Research Needed Information	What evidence do you need, and where do you find it?
4	**E**	Explore Options	What are the viable solutions, and which is best?
5	**SS**	Submit Proposal or Report	How do you package your work for decision?
6	**S**	Sustain Efforts to Implement	How do you keep momentum after approval?
7	**IT**	Iterate and Improve	How do you learn from results and improve?

The mnemonic spells **ADDRESS IT** because that is exactly what CSW does: it addresses the problem so the decision-maker does not have to.

How to Read This Guidebook

If You Are New to CSW

Read sequentially. Start with Chapter 1 to understand why CSW matters. Move through Chapters 2-3 to see where CSW fits in BARMM and which type applies to your work. Then follow Chapters 4-10 step by step.

If You Are Experienced but Want Structure

Go directly to Chapter 3 (Types of CSW) and identify which type matches your current assignment. Then read the relevant ADDRESS IT step chapters (4-10) for that type. Use the appendix templates to structure your output.

If You Supervise Staff Who Produce CSW

Start with Chapter 13 (Writing Standards and Quality Assurance) and Chapter 14 (Building a CSW Culture). Use Appendix F (Quality Review Checklist) to evaluate staff work. Use Appendix J (Competency Assessment Tool) to identify training needs.

If You Design or Facilitate CSW Training

Each ADDRESS IT step chapter (4-10) ends with a “Consequences of Skipping” section you can use as case-based discussion material. Appendix K provides three annotated sample CSW documents for classroom analysis.

Conventions Used in This Guidebook

Throughout this guidebook, you will encounter the following formatting conventions:

- **Bold text** highlights key terms, framework names, and definitions
- *Italic text* marks document titles and template names on first use
- **TIP** callouts provide practical advice from experienced practitioners
- **CAUTION** callouts warn about common mistakes and their real consequences
- **BANGSAMORO NOTE** callouts highlight adaptations specific to BARMM governance
- Blockquoted text presents verbatim legal provisions from the BOL, BAAs, or national laws
- Section references use “Chapter X, Section X.X” for cross-referencing

Companion Guidebook

This CSW Guidebook complements the **Bill Drafting Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Parliament**. Where the Bill Drafting Guidebook focuses on the technical craft of writing legislation, this guidebook covers the analytical and decision-support work that precedes, accompanies, and follows legislative action.

If you prepare legislative briefers, use both guidebooks together. This guidebook gives you the analytical process. The Bill Drafting Guidebook gives you drafting conventions and legal formatting standards.

Now turn to Chapter 1 to understand the philosophy behind Complete Staff Work and why it is the foundation of effective Bangsamoro governance.

Back to Table of Contents

01

The Philosophy of Complete Staff Work

Every time you submit incomplete work to your superior, you transfer your job to them. They stop leading and start fixing. The hours they spend rewriting your memo, verifying your data, or hunting for the option you failed to consider are hours stolen from governance.

Complete Staff Work exists to prevent this. It is a professional discipline with a single standard: **your superior should only need to approve or disapprove.**

1.1 What CSW Means in Practice

1.1.1 The Decision-Maker Should Only Need to Approve or Disapprove

This is the core principle. Memorize it. Test every output against it.

When you hand a document to your supervisor, ask yourself: "If I were the decision-maker, could I sign this right now?" If the answer is no, your work is not complete.

Complete means the document contains:

- A clear statement of the problem
- Evidence gathered through research
- Multiple options analyzed against objective criteria
- A recommended course of action with justification
- An implementation plan with timelines, resources, and responsibilities
- A call to action that tells the decision-maker exactly what to approve

Incomplete means any of these are missing, vague, or unsupported.

The test is binary. Your supervisor should be able to read your output, understand the situation, evaluate your recommendation, and make a decision. They should not need to conduct their own research, generate their own options, or rewrite your prose to make it understandable.

> **TIP:** Before submitting, read your document as if you have never seen the subject before. If any section raises a question you have not answered, the work is not complete.

1.1.2 CSW as Professional Discipline, Not Bureaucratic Burden

CSW is not paperwork for the sake of paperwork. It is a thinking discipline. The documents you produce are artifacts of rigorous analysis, not administrative exercises.

Consider the difference:

Without CSW	With CSW
Staff submits a one-paragraph memo asking for a decision	Staff submits a structured analysis with problem, options, recommendation, and implementation plan
Supervisor asks: "What about the legal implications?"	Legal implications are addressed in Section 4.5
Decision is delayed while staff goes back to research	Decision is made in the same meeting
Implementation fails because no one planned for resource constraints	Implementation plan includes resource requirements and risk mitigation

CSW saves time. It saves your supervisor's time. It saves the organization's time. The upfront investment in analysis and structure pays for itself many times over.

> **CAUTION:** The most common misconception about CSW is that it slows things down. The opposite is true. Decisions made on incomplete analysis get reversed, amended, or abandoned. Complete analysis leads to decisions that stick.

1.2 CSW in the Philippine Public Service Tradition

1.2.1 MC No. 72/2019 and MC No. 2/2022

Complete Staff Work has formal legal backing in the Philippine government.

Memorandum Circular No. 72, Series of 2019 (MC 72/2019) issued by the Civil Service Commission (CSC) establishes CSW as a standard for all national government agencies. It defines CSW as:

> The product of a study of a problem, which includes presentation of a recommended action by staff personnel, and is carried to the point where all that remains to be done on the part of the head of the office is to approve or disapprove.

The MC requires that staff work be:

- **Thorough** in research and analysis
- **Complete** in presenting all relevant information
- **Decision-ready** so the approving authority can act immediately

Memorandum Circular No. 2, Series of 2022 (MC 2/2022) extends the CSW requirement to local government units (LGUs). It recognizes that LGUs, like national agencies, need structured staff work to improve governance quality.

Both circulars share a common vision: government staff should produce work that enables, not burdens, their superiors.

1.2.2 Adaptation for Bangsamoro Autonomous Governance

The Bangsamoro Autonomous Region operates under its own governance structure established by Republic Act No. 11054 (the Bangsamoro Organic Law, or BOL). BARMM is neither a national agency nor a traditional LGU. It is an autonomous region with its own parliament, ministries, and administrative system.

This creates a unique CSW context:

Parliament staff produce legislative briefers, committee reports, and oversight analyses that support 80 Members of Parliament. Their CSW outputs directly shape legislation affecting 4.4 million Bangsamoro people.

Ministry, Office, and Agency (MOA) staff produce policy recommendations, budget requests, project proposals, and administrative actions that drive the executive functions of BARMM governance.

LGU staff within BARMM produce staff work that must align with both BOL mandates and the local governance framework.

The ADDRESS IT framework in this guidebook adapts MC 72/2019 and MC 2/2022 for these three BARMM contexts. The core principle remains the same: the decision-maker should only need to approve or disapprove. But the templates, examples, and procedures are tailored to Bangsamoro governance.

> **BANGSAMORO NOTE:** Unlike national government CSW, Bangsamoro CSW must account for the BOL's special provisions on Shari'ah governance (Article X), moral governance principles (BAA 13), indigenous peoples' rights, and the Bangsamoro Development Plan (BDP) alignment requirement. Chapters 2 and 13 address these unique dimensions.

1.3 Why CSW Matters for the Bangsamoro People

The Bangsamoro Autonomous Region is young. The BOL was ratified in 2019. BARMM institutions are still being built. Every decision made today shapes the governance culture that will endure for generations.

In this context, CSW is not just an administrative tool. It is a governance value.

CSW Strengthens Transparency

When staff work is documented — with clear problem statements, cited evidence, and analyzed options — decisions become traceable. The public can understand *why* a policy was adopted, *what* alternatives were considered, and *who* recommended the chosen course of action.

Without CSW, decisions happen in corridors and text messages. Rationale is lost. Accountability evaporates.

CSW Builds Institutional Memory

Staff rotate. Officials change. Political transitions happen. If decisions rest in the heads of individuals, they leave when those individuals leave.

CSW creates a documented record. The next analyst who picks up a file can trace the analysis, understand the reasoning, and build on the work rather than starting from scratch.

CSW Protects Against Audit Findings

The Commission on Audit (COA) does not just check whether money was spent correctly. It checks whether decisions were made with due diligence. A properly documented CSW — showing research, options analysis, and justification — is your best defense against audit observations.

CSW Enables Evidence-Based Governance

BARMM faces complex challenges: post-conflict development, poverty reduction, infrastructure gaps, education access, health service delivery, and cultural preservation. These challenges demand evidence-based solutions, not guesswork.

CSW is the mechanism that forces evidence into the decision-making process. When you conduct Step 3 (Research) and Step 4 (Explore Options) rigorously, you replace assumptions with data.

CSW Upholds Moral Governance

The Bangsamoro governance framework emphasizes **moral governance** — decision-making grounded in ethical principles, accountability, and public trust. BAA No. 13 (Bangsamoro Administrative Code) establishes this as a governing principle.

CSW supports moral governance by ensuring decisions are:

- Based on evidence, not favoritism
- Documented, not hidden
- Analyzed for impact on all stakeholders, not just the politically connected
- Reviewed for compliance with Shari'ah principles where applicable

> **BANGSAMORO NOTE:** The concept of **amanah** (trust) in Islamic governance aligns directly with CSW's accountability requirement. When you produce complete, transparent, evidence-based staff work, you fulfill your amanah to the Bangsamoro people. When you cut corners, you betray it.

The Cost of Incomplete Staff Work

Consider what happens when CSW fails in BARMM:

- A **budget request** without proper justification is denied by Parliament, delaying a flagship program by a fiscal year
- A **legislative briefer** with inaccurate data leads an MP to ask the wrong questions during budget deliberation, missing a critical oversight issue
- A **project proposal** without stakeholder consultation is approved but faces community resistance during implementation, wasting public funds
- A **legal opinion** that misreads a BOL provision leads to a policy challenge in the Supreme Court
- A **personnel action** without proper documentation results in a COA disallowance, requiring officers to personally refund the government

Every one of these failures is preventable through Complete Staff Work.

Chapter Summary

- CSW means your superior should only need to approve or disapprove
- MC 72/2019 and MC 2/2022 provide the legal basis; this guidebook adapts them for BARMM
- CSW is a thinking discipline, not a bureaucratic burden
- In the Bangsamoro context, CSW strengthens transparency, institutional memory, audit readiness, evidence-based governance, and moral governance
- The ADDRESS IT framework provides a structured, seven-step process for achieving the CSW standard

Next: Chapter 2 shows how CSW operates within the Bangsamoro governance structure — Parliament, MOAs, and LGUs.

Back to Table of Contents

02

CSW in the Bangsamoro Context

Your CSW output does not exist in a vacuum. It exists within a governance system defined by the BOL, shaped by the Bangsamoro Development Plan, and operated by specific institutions with distinct mandates. If you do not understand this system, your staff work will miss the mark.

This chapter maps the terrain. You need to know who makes decisions, under what authority, and toward what goals before you can produce staff work that serves them.

2.1 The Bangsamoro Governance Structure

2.1.1 Parliament (BTA) and Its Legislative Functions

The Bangsamoro Transitional Authority (BTA) serves as the interim government of BARMM. The **Bangsamoro Parliament** is its legislative body, composed of 80 Members of Parliament (MPs) who exercise legislative, appropriation, and oversight powers.

Parliament operates through **standing committees**. Each committee focuses on a policy area: finance and budget, education, health, public works, local government, natural resources, and others. Committee staff produce the CSW that drives committee deliberations.

What CSW looks like in Parliament:

Output	Purpose	Decision-Maker
Legislative Briefer (13-section format)	Analyze a bill or policy issue for committee deliberation	Committee Chairperson and Members
Budget Briefer (BB01-BB13)	Analyze an agency's budget for appropriation deliberation	Committee on Finance and Budget
Committee Report	Present committee findings and recommendations to plenary	Parliament in plenary session
Oversight Report	Assess implementation of laws or programs	Oversight committee members
Position Paper	State the MP's or committee's stance on an issue	The MP or committee leadership

Parliament staff CSW has a distinct feature: it serves **legislators who make decisions collectively**. A legislative briefer does not end with a single approval. It feeds into committee discussion, amendment, and voting. Your CSW must anticipate questions from multiple MPs with different perspectives.

> **BANGSAMORO NOTE:** The BTA Parliament operates under the Bangsamoro Transition Plan and BOL provisions. Unlike the Philippine Congress, BTA Members are appointed (not elected during the transition period). This means Parliament dynamics differ from a typical elected legislature. Your CSW should account for the transition context and the institution-building mandate.

2.1.2 Ministries, Offices, and Agencies (MOAs)

The executive branch of BARMM consists of **Ministries, Offices, and Agencies (MOAs)**. These entities implement the laws Parliament enacts and deliver services to the Bangsamoro people.

Key MOAs include:

- **Ministry of Finance, Budget, and Management (MFBM)** — fiscal policy, budget preparation, revenue management
- **Ministry of Basic, Higher and Technical Education (MBHTE)** — education delivery and scholarship programs
- **Ministry of Public Works (MPW)** — infrastructure development
- **Ministry of Social Services and Development (MSSD)** — social protection and welfare
- **Ministry of the Interior and Local Government (MILG)** — LGU supervision and local governance
- **Ministry of Health (MOH)** — health service delivery
- **Office of the Chief Minister (OCM)** — executive coordination and policy direction

What CSW looks like in MOAs:

Output	Purpose	Decision-Maker
Policy Recommendation	Propose a policy change or new initiative	Minister or Director
Budget Request	Justify funding allocation for programs or projects	MFBM and Parliament

Output	Purpose	Decision-Maker
Project Proposal	Design a new program or infrastructure project	Minister, with MFBM clearance
Personnel Action	Justify hiring, promotion, or reorganization	HR committee and Minister
Procurement Justification	Support procurement decisions with analysis	BAC and head of agency
Legal Opinion	Analyze legal questions affecting the agency	Minister or legal counsel

MOA staff CSW flows upward through a **hierarchical approval chain**: staff member to division chief to director to undersecretary to minister. Each level reviews and endorses before the document reaches the final decision-maker. Your transmittal memorandum (see Chapter 8) must reflect this chain.

2.1.3 Local Government Units Under BARMM

BARMM encompasses provinces, cities, municipalities, and barangays. Under the BOL, these LGUs operate within the autonomous region's governance framework while also adhering to the Local Government Code (RA 7160) as modified by applicable BAAs.

LGU staff produce CSW for local chief executives (governors, mayors, punong barangays) and local legislative bodies (Sangguniang Panlalawigan, Sangguniang Bayan/Panlungsod, Sangguniang Barangay).

What CSW looks like in LGUs:

Output	Purpose	Decision-Maker
General CSW	Analyze any local governance issue	Local Chief Executive
Ordinance Analysis	Support drafting or amending local ordinances	Sanggunian
Budget Proposal	Justify local budget items	Local Finance Committee
Project Proposal	Propose local infrastructure or social projects	Local Development Council

MC 2/2022 specifically mandates CSW for LGUs. If you work in an LGU within BARMM, you operate under both the national MC and the Bangsamoro governance framework.

2.2 How CSW Serves Both Legislative and Executive Functions

CSW bridges the legislative-executive divide. Consider a practical example:

The Bangsamoro ECCD Bill — A proposed law localizing the national Early Childhood Care and Development framework for BARMM. This bill required CSW at multiple levels:

1. **Legislative staff** prepared a 13-section legislative briefer analyzing the bill's provisions, constitutional basis, budgetary impact, and alignment with BOL mandates
2. **MBHTE staff** prepared a policy recommendation detailing the current state of ECCD in BARMM, coverage gaps, and resource requirements
3. **MFBM staff** prepared a budget impact analysis estimating the fiscal cost of implementation
4. **Committee staff** prepared a committee report synthesizing all inputs for plenary deliberation

Each of these is CSW. Each follows ADDRESS IT. But each serves a different decision-maker through a different output type.

The framework is the same. The application differs by institutional context.

2.3 The Legal Framework: BOL, BAA 13, and Moral Governance

Your CSW must be grounded in the legal framework that governs BARMM. Three instruments are foundational:

Republic Act No. 11054 — The Bangsamoro Organic Law (BOL)

The BOL is the supreme law of BARMM. Any CSW output — whether a policy recommendation, legislative briefer, or project proposal — must be checked against BOL provisions. Common BOL references in CSW include:

> **Article V, Section 2.** The Bangsamoro Government shall have the authority to create its own sources of revenue, levy taxes, fees, and charges, and to issue bonds, subject to such guidelines and limitations as the Congress may impose.
>
> **Article VII, Section 1.** The Bangsamoro Government shall have the power to create, divide, merge, abolish, or substantially alter boundaries of municipalities and barangays.
>
> **Article X, Section 1.** The Bangsamoro Government shall have competence over the Shari'ah justice system.

When your CSW touches revenue, LGU boundaries, Shari'ah matters, indigenous peoples' rights (Article IX, Section 3), or intergovernmental relations (Article VI), cite the specific BOL provision. Do not paraphrase. Quote verbatim and provide the Article and Section number.

BAA No. 13 — The Bangsamoro Administrative Code

BAA 13 establishes the administrative structure and processes of BARMM. It defines how MOAs are organized, how authority is delegated, and how government business is conducted.

For CSW purposes, BAA 13 is relevant when:

- Your output involves an agency's mandate or organizational structure
- You are defining approval hierarchies for transmittal
- You are analyzing compliance requirements for administrative actions
- You need to reference the governance principles that guide BARMM operations

Moral Governance

The Bangsamoro governance framework emphasizes **moral governance** as a foundational principle. This is not just an aspiration. It shapes how CSW is evaluated.

Moral governance requires that staff work:

- **Serves the public interest**, not private or partisan agendas
- **Is truthful** in its presentation of facts and analysis
- **Is transparent** in its methodology and sources
- **Is accountable** — the analyst stands behind their work
- **Respects cultural and religious values** of the Bangsamoro people
- **Considers equity** — who benefits and who is disadvantaged by each option

When you write the "Consequences of Inaction" section (Step 2) or the "Impact Analysis" section (Step 4), moral governance demands that you assess effects on the most vulnerable communities, not just the political calculus.

> **TIP:** Add a "Moral Governance Check" to your self-review before submitting any CSW output. Ask: Does this serve the Bangsamoro people? Is the evidence honest? Have I considered impacts on vulnerable groups? Would I be comfortable if this analysis were published in full?

2.4 The Bangsamoro Development Plan and CSW Alignment

The **Bangsamoro Development Plan (BDP) 2023-2028** is the master planning document for BARMM. It articulates six development goals, eight core strategies, and specific targets across all governance sectors.

Every CSW output should demonstrate alignment with the BDP. This is not optional. Decision-makers in BARMM — whether Parliament committees or ministry executives — evaluate proposals against development plan priorities.

How to Align Your CSW with the BDP

Step 1: Identify the relevant BDP goal. The six goals cover governance, social development, economic development, environmental sustainability, infrastructure, and peace and security. Determine which goal(s) your CSW addresses.

Step 2: Map to a BDP strategy. Under each goal, the BDP specifies strategies. Map your recommendation to the specific strategy it advances.

Step 3: Reference BDP targets. The BDP includes measurable targets. If your CSW relates to education, cite the BDP's education targets. If it relates to infrastructure, cite the infrastructure targets.

Step 4: Document the alignment. In your CSW output, include a brief section (or a row in your options matrix) showing how your recommendation advances BDP goals. This strengthens your case and helps the decision-maker see the strategic value.

Example alignment statement:

> This project proposal aligns with **BDP Goal 2: Strengthened Social Development** and specifically advances **Strategy 2.3: Expanding Access to Quality Education**. The proposal targets BDP Indicator 2.3.4 (Gross Enrollment Rate in Early Childhood Education) and aims to increase coverage from 42% to 58% within the project's three-year implementation period.

When Your Recommendation Does Not Align with the BDP

Sometimes your analysis reveals a need that falls outside current BDP priorities. This is not a disqualification. Document the misalignment honestly. Explain why the need exists despite not being explicitly reflected in the BDP. Let the decision-maker weigh the trade-off.

Hiding a misalignment undermines your credibility. Surfacing it demonstrates analytical integrity.

The Intergovernmental Dimension

BARMM does not operate in isolation. CSW in the Bangsamoro context must account for intergovernmental relations:

BARMM and the National Government. Under the BOL, certain powers are shared or concurrent. When your CSW touches areas like taxation, natural resources, or justice, you must identify whether the power is exclusive to BARMM, shared, or retained by the national government.

BARMM and LGUs. The relationship between the autonomous region government and its constituent LGUs is defined by the BOL and the Bangsamoro Local Governance Code. Your CSW should account for LGU capacity, fiscal autonomy, and coordination requirements.

BARMM and External Partners. Development partners, international organizations, and civil society organizations operate within BARMM. When your CSW involves external funding, technical assistance, or partnership arrangements, identify the relevant stakeholders and coordination mechanisms.

> **CAUTION:** A common CSW failure in BARMM is assuming that BARMM has full authority over every issue within its territory. The BOL defines specific exclusive, concurrent, and reserved powers. Always check the BOL before claiming BARMM jurisdiction in your CSW.

Chapter Summary

- BARMM governance operates through three institutional settings: Parliament, MOAs, and LGUs — each requiring different CSW output types
- Parliament CSW serves collective decision-making by committee; MOA CSW flows through hierarchical approval chains; LGU CSW serves local chief executives and sanggunians
- The BOL, BAA 13, and moral governance principles form the legal framework that every CSW output must respect
- The BDP 2023-2028 provides the strategic alignment standard — every CSW recommendation should demonstrate how it advances development goals

- Intergovernmental relations (BARMM-national, BARMM-LGU, BARMM-external partners) add complexity that your CSW must address

Next: Chapter 3 introduces the nine types of CSW documents used in BARMM and helps you determine which type matches your assignment.

Back to Table of Contents

03

Types of CSW in BARMM

Your first decision when you receive an assignment is: **what type of CSW output does this require?** The wrong format wastes your time and frustrates your decision-maker. A budget question needs a budget briefer, not a general memo. A legal question needs a legal opinion, not a project proposal.

This chapter describes the nine CSW types used in BARMM and provides a decision matrix to help you choose correctly every time.

3.1 Overview: The CSW Type Table

Code	Type	Primary Use	Typical Decision-Maker	Sections
LA	Legislative Analysis Briefer	Analyze bills, resolutions, or policy issues for committee deliberation	Committee Chairperson, MPs	13 sections
BB	Budget Briefer	Analyze agency budgets for appropriation review	Committee on Finance and Budget	13 sections (BB01-BB13)
PR	Policy Recommendation	Recommend a policy change or new initiative	Minister, Director, Chief Minister	Bardach's Eightfold Path adapted
LO	Legal Opinion	Provide legal analysis and advice	Minister, legal counsel, committee chair	8 sections (LO01-LO08)
PP	Project Proposal	Propose a new project, program, or initiative	Minister, MFBM, Parliament	10 sections (PP01-PP10)
PA	Personnel/ Administrative Action	Justify hiring, promotion, reorganization, or administrative decisions	HR committee, Minister, head of office	Variable
SV	Supervision System	Design organizational supervision frameworks	Head of entity, management committee	10 sections (SV01-SV10)

Code	Type	Primary Use	Typical Decision-Maker	Sections
GN	General CSW	Universal template for issues that do not fit a specialized type	Any decision-maker	9 sections (GN01-GN09)
CU	Custom CSW	Hybrid or entity-specific formats combining elements from other types	Variable	Variable

Every type follows the ADDRESS IT process. The difference is how the output is structured and what content each section requires.

3.2 Legislative Analysis Briefer (LA) — The 13-Section Format

The Legislative Analysis Briefer is the standard CSW output for Parliament staff. It provides a comprehensive analysis of a bill, resolution, or policy issue in 13 structured sections.

When to use: Any time a committee needs analysis of pending legislation, oversight issues, or policy questions.

Structure:

Section	Content	ADDRESS IT Step
I. Overview	Bill title, author, committee referral, status	Step 1 (Analyze)
II. Brief Description	Summary of the bill's key provisions	Step 1 (Analyze)
III. Previous Proceedings	Legislative history and related measures	Step 2 (Define)
IV. Implementing Agency	Agency responsible for implementation	Step 1 (Analyze)
V. Appropriations Needed	Estimated budget impact	Step 3 (Research)
VI. Objects of Expenditure	Specific budget line items	Step 3 (Research)
VII. Source of Funds	Where the money comes from	Step 3 (Research)
VIII. Sectoral Analysis	Impact on specific sectors or communities	Step 3 (Research)
IX. BOL Alignment	Constitutional and BOL consistency check	Step 1 + Step 3
X. Parliamentary Strategy	Recommended approach for committee action	Step 4 (Explore)
XI. Proposed Amendments	Specific textual amendments recommended	Step 4 (Explore)

Section	Content	ADDRESS IT Step
XII. Recommended Vote	Approval, deferral, or disapproval with rationale	Step 5 (Submit)
XIII. Strategic Intelligence	Broader political and policy context	Step 4 + Step 5

> **TIP:** Section XIII (Strategic Intelligence) is what separates a good briefer from a great one. This is where you provide the context the committee needs to make a politically informed decision — stakeholder positions, potential controversies, timing considerations, and implementation risks. Do not skip it.

Chapter 11 provides detailed guidance on producing Legislative Analysis Briefers within the ADDRESS IT framework.

3.3 Budget Briefer (BB) — The BB-Coded Template

The Budget Briefer is the standard CSW output for analyzing agency budgets during Parliament's appropriation process.

When to use: During budget deliberation season, when committees review the Bangsamoro Expenditure Program (BEP) and each agency's budget request.

Structure:

Section	Content	ADDRESS IT Step
BB01	Ministry/Agency/Office	Step 1 (Analyze)
BB02	BEP Reference (code/page)	Step 1 (Analyze)
BB03	Mandate	Step 1 (Analyze)
BB04	Overall Development Goals	Step 2 (Define)
BB05	Organizational Outcomes (current year)	Step 3 (Research)
BB06	Budget Comparison (PS, MOOE, CO) — multi-year	Step 3 + Step 4
BB07	Existing PPAS (Tier 1)	Step 3 + Step 4
BB08	New PPAS (Tier 2)	Step 4 (Explore)
BB09	Related Laws and Policies	Step 1 (Analyze)
BB10	Shari'ah Analysis (where applicable)	Step 1 + Step 2
BB11	Gender Analysis	Step 3 (Research)
BB12	Recommendations and Proposed Actions	Step 4 + Step 5
BB13	Executive Summary	Step 5 (Submit)

Key rule: BB13 (Executive Summary) is always written last. It captures the essence of the entire analysis in one to two paragraphs. This is what the MP reads first.

> **CAUTION:** Budget briefers require verified numerical data. Every figure — appropriations, obligations, disbursements, variances — must trace to an official source (BEP, GAAB, financial statements). A single wrong number destroys the briefer's credibility. Cross-check every figure before transmittal.

3.4 Policy Recommendation (PR) — Bardach's Eightfold Path

The Policy Recommendation is the standard CSW output for proposing a new policy, modifying an existing one, or responding to a policy challenge.

When to use: Any time a minister, director, or committee needs a recommended course of action on a policy question.

Structure (adapted from Eugene Bardach's Eightfold Path):

Step	Section	ADDRESS IT Mapping
1	Define the Problem	Step 2 (Define)
2	Assemble the Evidence	Step 3 (Research)
3	Construct the Alternatives	Step 4 (Explore)
4	Select the Criteria	Step 4 (Explore)
5	Project the Outcomes	Step 4 (Explore)
6	Confront the Trade-Offs	Step 4 (Explore)
7	Decide	Step 5 (Submit)
8	Tell Your Story	Step 5 (Submit)

Bardach's framework integrates naturally with ADDRESS IT. Steps 1-3 of ADDRESS IT map directly to Bardach's Steps 1-3. ADDRESS IT's Step 4 (Explore Options) expands Bardach's Steps 3-6. ADDRESS IT then adds implementation (Step 6) and iteration (Step 7), which Bardach does not cover explicitly.

Example BARMM policy recommendation:

Problem: BARMM scholarship recipients have a 35% dropout rate after the first year.

Evidence: Exit interviews with 200 dropped scholars show three root causes: inadequate stipend for cost of living outside BARMM, weak academic preparation from K-12, and lack of mentoring support.

Alternatives: (A) Increase stipend by 40%, (B) Establish mandatory pre-college bridging program, (C) Deploy regional mentors in 10 host cities.

Recommendation: Implement Options B and C simultaneously. Option A alone treats symptoms without addressing academic readiness or isolation.

3.5 Legal Opinion (LO)

The Legal Opinion provides legal analysis and advice on specific questions assigned by a decision-maker.

When to use: When a minister, committee chair, or head of office needs a legal assessment before making a decision.

Structure:

Section	Content	ADDRESS IT Step
LO01	Query / Legal Question	Step 1 (Analyze)
LO02	Executive Summary (write last)	Step 5 (Submit)
LO03	Factual Background	Step 1 (Analyze)
LO04	Legal Issues Defined	Step 2 (Define)
LO05	Applicable Legal Framework	Steps 1 + 3
LO06	Legal Analysis	Steps 3 + 4
LO07	Legal Opinion / Recommendation	Steps 4 + 5
LO08	Proposed Next Steps	Steps 5 + 6

Key principle: A legal opinion must present both sides of an argument before stating a conclusion. Even when the law seems clear, identify the competing interpretation and explain why it fails. This demonstrates thoroughness and protects the decision-maker from surprise challenges.

> **BANGSAMORO NOTE:** Legal opinions in BARMM often involve BOL interpretation, the interaction between BAAs and national laws, and Shari'ah law provisions. Always check Article X of the BOL when the issue has a Shari'ah dimension. Consult the Dar al-Ifta when needed.

3.6 Project Proposal (PP)

The Project Proposal presents a new project, program, or initiative for approval and funding.

When to use: When proposing a new development project, service delivery program, infrastructure initiative, or institutional reform.

Structure:

Section	Content	ADDRESS IT Step
PP01	Project Title and Proponent	Step 1
PP02	Executive Summary (write last)	Step 5
PP03	Background and Context	Step 1
PP04	Problem/Need Statement	Step 2
PP05	Research and Evidence Base	Step 3
PP06	Project Description	Step 4
PP07	Budget and Resource Requirements	Step 4
PP08	Implementation Plan	Steps 5 + 6
PP09	Monitoring and Evaluation	Step 7
PP10	Appendices	Supporting documents

Key requirement: PP07 must include a detailed budget breakdown by component (Personnel Services, MOOE, Capital Outlay) and identify the funding source (block grant, Special Development Fund, General Appropriations Act, or external funding). Vague budgets kill proposals.

3.7 Personnel/Administrative Action (PA)

The Personnel/Administrative Action supports decisions on hiring, promotion, reorganization, disciplinary cases, or other administrative matters.

When to use: Any time a personnel or administrative decision needs documented justification.

Key elements:

- **The action requested** — State exactly what you are asking the decision-maker to approve
- **Legal basis** — Cite the CSC rules, BAA 13 provisions, or office policies that authorize the action
- **Justification** — Explain why the action is necessary, supported by data (staffing ratios, workload analysis, performance records)
- **Options considered** — Show that alternatives were evaluated before arriving at the recommendation
- **Financial impact** — Calculate the cost implications (salary differentials, benefits, training costs)
- **Implementation steps** — Outline the administrative process after approval

> **CAUTION:** Personnel actions are among the most audit-sensitive CSW outputs. Every step must be documented. Every requirement must be met. Missing a single CSC rule can result in a disallowance. Follow the checklist meticulously.

3.8 Supervision System (SV)

The Supervision System template is used to design or formalize an organizational supervision framework.

When to use: When a head of entity or office director needs to establish a structured supervision system that integrates CSW, performance management, delegation, and staff development.

Structure:

Section	Content
SV01	Organization Profile
SV02	Supervisory Framework
SV03	Supervisory Roles and Responsibilities
SV04	CSW Integration
SV05	Performance Management System
SV06	Delegation of Authority
SV07	Feedback and Coaching Framework
SV08	Staff Development Plan
SV09	Accountability and Compliance
SV10	Continuous Improvement

This is a meta-CSW document: it defines how CSW itself is managed within the organization. Section SV04 explicitly maps how ADDRESS IT fits into the supervisory workflow.

3.9 General CSW (GN) — The Universal Template

When your assignment does not fit any specialized type, use the General CSW template. It follows ADDRESS IT directly as the section structure.

When to use: Any issue that needs structured analysis but does not require a specialized format. Examples: responding to a directive from the Chief Minister, analyzing a cross-cutting governance issue, preparing a position paper.

Structure:

Section	Content	ADDRESS IT Step
GN01	Executive Summary (write last)	Step 5
GN02	Background and Context	Step 1
GN03	Problem or Need Statement	Step 2
GN04	Research Findings	Step 3
GN05	Options Analysis	Step 4
GN06	Recommended Solution	Steps 4 + 5
GN07	Implementation Plan	Steps 5 + 6
GN08	Conclusion and Call to Action	Step 5
GN09	Appendices	Supporting documents

The GN template includes an **Options Matrix** in GN05:

Criterion	Option A	Option B	Option C
Feasibility			
Effectiveness			
Efficiency			

Criterion	Option A	Option B	Option C
Sustainability			
Alignment			
Overall Rank			

> **TIP:** The GN template is your fallback. When in doubt about which type to use, start with GN. You can always restructure into a specialized format later if needed.

3.10 When to Use Which Type

Use this decision matrix:

Start here: What is the nature of your assignment?

If your assignment involves...	Use this type	Template code
Analyzing a bill or resolution for committee deliberation	Legislative Analysis Briefer	LA
Reviewing an agency's budget for appropriation	Budget Briefer	BB
Recommending a policy change or new initiative	Policy Recommendation	PR
Answering a specific legal question	Legal Opinion	LO
Proposing a new project or program	Project Proposal	PP
Justifying a personnel or administrative decision	Personnel/Administrative Action	PA
Designing an organizational supervision framework	Supervision System	SV
Analyzing any other governance issue	General CSW	GN
A combination of the above or a unique requirement	Custom CSW	CU

Quick Decision Flowchart

1. **Is it about legislation?** Use LA.
2. **Is it about a budget?** Use BB.
3. **Is it a legal question?** Use LO.
4. **Is it a new project?** Use PP.
5. **Is it about personnel?** Use PA.
6. **Is it a policy question?** Use PR.

7. **Is it about supervision systems?** Use SV.
8. **None of the above?** Use GN.
9. **Multiple types apply?** Use CU (combine relevant sections from two or more templates).

When to Use Custom CSW (CU)

Custom CSW is appropriate when:

- Your assignment spans multiple domains (e.g., a project proposal that requires legal analysis)
- Your entity has an established internal format that differs from the standard templates
- The decision-maker has specified a particular output structure

When building a Custom CSW, always maintain the ADDRESS IT sequence. Even if you restructure the sections, ensure every step is represented. The framework is the constant; the format is flexible.

> **BANGSAMORO NOTE:** Some BARMM entities have developed their own CSW formats through practice. If your office has an established template that works, you do not need to abandon it. Instead, map its sections to ADDRESS IT steps to ensure completeness. The ADDRESS IT framework is a quality standard, not a formatting mandate.

Chapter Summary

- Nine CSW types serve different decision-making needs: LA, BB, PR, LO, PP, PA, SV, GN, and CU
- Every type follows the ADDRESS IT process; only the output structure differs
- Use the decision matrix to select the right type for your assignment
- The General CSW (GN) template is the universal fallback
- Custom CSW (CU) combines elements from multiple types when needed
- All templates include an executive summary that is written last

Next: Chapter 4 begins the ADDRESS IT process with Step 1 — Analyze the Context.

Back to Table of Contents

04

Step 1: Analyze the Context (A)

You received an assignment. Before you open a blank document, stop. The most common CSW failure happens in the first five minutes: staff start writing before they understand what they are writing about.

Step 1 prevents this. It forces you to examine the assignment, the institution, the stakeholders, the environment, and the legal landscape before producing a single word of output. Skip this step, and everything that follows rests on assumptions.

4.1 Understanding the Assignment

4.1.1 Clarifying Purpose, Objectives, and Desired Outcomes

Every CSW begins with an assignment. Someone asked you to do something. Your first task is to make sure you understand exactly what they asked.

Answer these questions before you proceed:

Question	Why It Matters
Who assigned this?	Determines the decision-maker and the approval chain
What is the specific task?	Defines the scope of your work
Why is this needed now?	Reveals urgency, triggers, and context
What is the desired outcome?	Tells you what success looks like
When is it due?	Sets your timeline for ADDRESS IT steps
What format does the decision-maker expect?	Determines your CSW type (Chapter 3)

Write down the answers. Do not carry them in your head. A written assignment brief — even a few bullet points — becomes your reference throughout the process.

Example:

> **Assignment Brief** - **Assigned by:** Committee Chairperson, Committee on Education - **Task:** Prepare a legislative briefer on the Bangsamoro ECCD Bill (BAA No. [pending]) - **Why now:** Bill is scheduled for committee deliberation on March 15 - **Desired outcome:** Committee members can deliberate with full understanding of the bill's provisions, budgetary impact, and BOL alignment - **Due date:** March 10 (5 working days before deliberation) - **Format:** 13-section Legislative Analysis Briefer (LA)

4.1.2 When the Assignment Is Unclear

Sometimes the assignment arrives vague: "Look into this." "Give me something on the budget." "Handle the MOA issue."

Do not guess. Clarify.

Ask your supervisor:

1. "What specific question do you want answered?"
2. "Who is the final decision-maker for this output?"
3. "Is there a precedent — has this been done before?"
4. "What is the deadline and the decision timeline?"
5. "What format do you prefer?"

> **TIP:** Document the clarification. Send a brief email or message summarizing what you understood. This protects you if the scope shifts later. "Per our discussion, I understand the assignment is ☑. I will deliver [Y] by [date]. Please confirm or correct."
>
> **CAUTION:** Never assume you understand a vague assignment. Producing 20 pages of analysis on the wrong question wastes everyone's time. Five minutes of clarification saves five days of rework.

4.2 Assessing Your Office's Function and Your Role

Your CSW must align with your office's mandate. A staff member in the Committee on Education should not produce a legal opinion on procurement law unless specifically directed.

Ask yourself:

- **What is my office's mandate?** Check the BOL, BAA 13, or the relevant organizational structure document.
- **Where does this assignment fit within our mandate?** If it does not fit, flag this to your supervisor. You may need to coordinate with another office.
- **What is my specific role?** Are you the lead analyst, the researcher, a reviewer, or a contributing team member?
- **What authority do I have?** Can you contact external stakeholders directly, or must requests go through your supervisor?

Understanding your position in the organizational structure determines how you gather information, who you consult, and how you transmit the final output.

4.3 Identifying Stakeholders (Primary and Secondary)

Every CSW issue has stakeholders — people, groups, or institutions affected by or interested in the outcome. Map them before you start your analysis.

Stakeholder Categories

Category	Definition	Example (ECCD Bill)
Primary	Directly affected by the decision	Children aged 0-6, parents, daycare workers, LGU daycare centers
Secondary	Indirectly affected or have an interest	MBHTE, MSSD, DILG, private ECCD providers, civil society organizations
Decision-makers	Those who approve, fund, or implement	Committee on Education, Parliament plenary, MFBM, LGUs
Opponents	Those who may resist the proposal	Private ECCD providers concerned about regulation, LGUs with fiscal constraints
Champions	Those who actively support the proposal	The bill's author, ECCD advocacy groups, UNICEF

Stakeholder Analysis Matrix

For each stakeholder, assess:

Stakeholder	Interest/ Concern	Influence Level	Position (Support/ Oppose/Neutral)	Engagement Strategy
		High / Medium / Low		

This matrix feeds directly into Step 2 (deliberation) and Step 4 (stakeholder validation of options).

> **TIP:** Do not limit your stakeholder analysis to the obvious actors. The most dangerous stakeholders are the ones you did not identify. Ask: “Who will be surprised by this decision? Who will be angry? Who was not consulted but should have been?”

4.4 Examining Internal and External Factors

4.4.1 PESTEL Analysis for BARMM Context

PESTEL is a structured tool for scanning the environment. Apply it to your specific CSW issue.

Factor	Questions to Ask	BARMM-Specific Considerations
Political	What is the political climate? Who supports or opposes? What is the legislative calendar?	BTA transition dynamics, party alignments, Chief Minister priorities, upcoming elections (post-BTA transition)
Economic	What are the budget constraints? What is the fiscal impact? What economic conditions affect implementation?	BARMM block grant ceiling, internal revenue capacity, poverty incidence (one of the highest in the Philippines), livelihood conditions
Social	What social groups are affected? What cultural values are at stake? What is public opinion?	Bangsamoro identity and cultural values, Moro-IP dynamics, internally displaced populations, clan structures
Technological	What technology is needed? What digital infrastructure exists? What tools are available?	Limited broadband in rural BARMM, digital literacy gaps, emerging e-governance platforms (e-Bangsamoro)
Environmental	Are there environmental impacts? Does the issue relate to natural resources?	Bangsamoro coastal and upland ecosystems, mining concerns, climate vulnerability, disaster-prone areas
Legal	What laws apply? What regulatory requirements exist?	BOL provisions, relevant BAAs, national laws, Shari'ah dimensions, intergovernmental powers

Not every PESTEL factor will be relevant to every CSW issue. Use the framework as a checklist, not a mandatory template. Focus on the factors that genuinely affect your analysis.

Example PESTEL application — School Building Program proposal:

Political: Aligns with the 12-point priority agenda on education. Strong parliamentary support expected. Ministry of Public Works coordination required.

Economic: Estimated cost: PHP 2.1 billion over 3 years. Funding source: block grant allocation. Current disbursement rate for infrastructure: 67% (needs improvement).

Social: 312 schools in BARMM without permanent structures. Communities prioritize education infrastructure in consultations.

Technological: Construction monitoring requires digital tracking system. Current paper-based monitoring causes 4-6 month reporting delays.

Environmental: Construction in flood-prone areas requires climate-resilient design standards. Environmental compliance certificates needed.

Legal: BOL Article VI, Section 13 grants BARMM authority over education. National Building Code applies. COA procurement regulations govern bidding.

4.5 Reviewing Relevant Laws, Policies, and Regulations

This is one of the most critical sub-steps. Incomplete legal review is a top-three cause of CSW rejection.

4.5.1 BOL Provisions

Start with the BOL. For any BARMM CSW, ask: "What does the BOL say about this subject?"

Check these BOL articles based on your topic:

Topic Area	Primary BOL Articles
Powers of the Bangsamoro Government	Article IV
Fiscal autonomy, taxation, block grant	Article V
Territory and jurisdiction	Article III
Education, health, social services	Article VI, Sections 11-15
Shari'ah and Islamic institutions	Article X
Indigenous peoples' rights	Article IX, Section 3
Intergovernmental relations	Article VI
Natural resources	Article XIII
Justice system	Article X
Security	Article XI

Quote the exact text. Provide the Article and Section number. Do not paraphrase BOL provisions in your CSW — accuracy matters.

4.5.2 Relevant BAAs

Bangsamoro Autonomy Acts (BAAs) are the laws enacted by Parliament. Check the BAA index for legislation relevant to your issue.

Common BAAs referenced in CSW:

BAA	Subject
BAA 13	Bangsamoro Administrative Code
BAA 18	Bangsamoro Education Code
BOL Art. XII	Revenue and Taxation (no separate BAA yet)
BAA 84	Budget System Act
BAA 35	Bangsamoro Electoral Code
BAA 17	Bangsamoro Civil Service Code

4.5.3 National Laws and IRRs

Some national laws apply within BARMM. Identify which ones affect your issue.

Areas where national laws commonly apply:

- Government procurement (RA 9184)
- Data privacy (RA 10173)
- Commission on Audit requirements
- Civil Service Commission rules
- Environmental laws
- Anti-corruption laws (RA 3019, RA 6713)

When national law and BAAs conflict, the BOL provides the resolution mechanism. Your legal review should flag any conflicts and cite the applicable provision.

4.6 Gathering Preliminary Data

Before diving into full research (Step 3), gather the baseline data you need to frame the issue.

Sources for preliminary data:

Source	What You Get
Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA) — BARMM	Population, poverty incidence, employment, education statistics
MFBM	Budget data, expenditure reports, financial statements
Implementing agencies	Program data, performance indicators, accomplishment reports
BDP 2023-2028	Development targets and baseline indicators
Bangsamoro Expenditure Program (BEP)	Budget allocations by agency and program
Previous CSW outputs	Prior analysis on the same or related issues
COA reports	Audit findings, compliance issues, financial observations

At this stage, you are not conducting exhaustive research. You are gathering enough information to:

1. Confirm the problem exists and is significant
2. Identify what you already know and what gaps remain
3. Estimate the scope and complexity of the full CSW effort
4. Refine your timeline for the remaining ADDRESS IT steps

> **TIP:** Check if someone in your office has already worked on this issue. Institutional memory saves enormous time. Ask your supervisor, check the filing system, and talk to colleagues who have been in the office longer.

4.7 Why This Step Matters — Consequences of Skipping

When you skip contextual analysis, every subsequent step suffers.

Without understanding the assignment: You produce an output that answers the wrong question. Your supervisor sends it back. You start over.

Without stakeholder mapping: You miss a critical stakeholder who opposes your recommendation. They surface during implementation and derail the project.

Without PESTEL analysis: You recommend an option that is politically impossible, economically unaffordable, or legally unauthorized.

Without legal review: Your recommendation violates a BOL provision or ignores a relevant BAA. The decision-maker is embarrassed. The CSW is discredited.

Without preliminary data: You estimate costs at PHP 500 million when the actual figure is PHP 2 billion. The entire analysis is built on a false foundation.

Real BARMM example of skipping Step 1:

A ministry staff member was asked to prepare a project proposal for a community water system in a conflict-affected municipality. The staff member skipped stakeholder analysis and legal review. The proposal was approved and funded. During implementation, the team discovered that the proposed site was within an ancestral domain of an indigenous community (IP). The BOL requires free, prior, and informed consent (FPIC) for projects affecting IP lands. The project was suspended for 14 months while FPIC was obtained. Total cost of the delay: PHP 4.3 million in idle equipment, mobilization fees, and redesign costs.

A 2-hour stakeholder analysis and legal review would have identified the IP dimension in Step 1. The FPIC process would have been integrated into the project timeline from the beginning.

Chapter Summary

- Clarify the assignment before starting. Write down the brief. When the assignment is vague, ask questions.
- Assess your office's mandate and your role. Ensure alignment.

- Map stakeholders: primary, secondary, decision-makers, opponents, champions.
- Apply PESTEL analysis adapted for the BARMM context.
- Review the BOL, relevant BAAs, and applicable national laws.
- Gather preliminary data to frame the issue and identify gaps.
- Skipping this step leads to wrong-question outputs, missed stakeholders, legal violations, and costly implementation failures.

Next: Chapter 5 takes the context you analyzed and uses it to define the problem clearly through Step 2 — Define and Deliberate.

Back to Table of Contents

05

Step 2: Define and Deliberate the Problem or Need (DD)

A vague problem produces a vague solution. If you cannot state the problem in one or two sentences, you do not understand it yet. Step 2 forces clarity. You articulate exactly what is wrong, deliberate with stakeholders to confirm your understanding, dig for root causes, and set measurable objectives.

This is where most weak CSW falls apart. Staff who skip straight from context to research end up collecting data without direction. They answer questions nobody asked.

5.1 Articulating the Problem Statement

5.1.1 Specific, Measurable, and Aligned

A good problem statement has three qualities:

Specific — It names the exact issue, not a broad category. "BARMM has an education problem" is not a problem statement. "42% of daycare centers in BARMM lack qualified ECCD teachers, resulting in non-compliance with RA 12199 standards" is a problem statement.

Measurable — It includes a quantifiable dimension. How many people are affected? What is the gap between current and desired states? What is the cost of the problem?

Aligned — It connects to the organization's mandate and the BDP. A problem that falls outside your office's mandate may be real, but it is not your problem to solve through CSW.

5.1.2 The Problem Statement Template

Use this structure to draft your problem statement:

> **[Who/What]** is experiencing **[specific problem]**, as evidenced by **[data/indicator]**. This results in **[negative consequences]**. The gap between the current state (**[baseline]**) and the desired state (**[target]**) is **[quantified gap]**. This falls within the mandate of **[your office/entity]** under **[legal basis]**.

Example — Good problem statement:

> An estimated 1,247 out of 2,985 public daycare centers in BARMM (42%) operate without qualified ECCD teachers, as documented in the MBHTE 2025 Status Report. This non-compliance with RA 12199 minimum standards results in substandard early learning outcomes for approximately 62,000 children aged 3-5. The gap between the current qualified-teacher ratio (58%) and the national standard (100%) is 42 percentage points. Addressing this gap falls within the mandate of MBHTE under BOL Article VI, Section 13 and is aligned with BDP Goal 2, Strategy 2.3.

Example — Weak problem statement:

> There are not enough ECCD teachers in BARMM. The situation needs improvement.

The weak version lacks specificity, data, consequences, and institutional alignment. It gives the analyst no direction for research or option generation.

5.2 Engaging Stakeholders in Deliberation

You defined the problem in draft form. Now test it against the people who live with it.

Deliberation means structured discussion with stakeholders who have relevant knowledge, authority, or experience. This is not a courtesy call. It is a data-gathering activity that strengthens your problem definition.

Who to consult:

Stakeholder Type	What They Contribute	Method
Subject matter experts	Technical accuracy, data validation	Interview, consultation
Affected communities	Ground-truth perspective on the problem	Focus group, community dialogue
Implementing agencies	Operational reality, feasibility constraints	Working meeting
Decision-maker (preliminary)	Direction confirmation, priority clarification	Brief check-in
Colleagues and peers	Alternative perspectives, blind spot identification	Informal discussion

How to deliberate effectively:

1. **Share your draft problem statement** before the meeting. Do not ask “What do you think the problem is?” Ask “Is this an accurate description of the problem?”
2. **Listen for corrections.** Stakeholders may reframe the problem in ways you did not anticipate. A community leader may say the teacher shortage is a symptom of a salary problem. That reframing changes your root cause analysis.
3. **Document inputs.** Record who said what. Note areas of consensus and disagreement.
4. **Revise the problem statement** based on deliberation findings.

> **TIP:** Deliberation is not consensus-building. You do not need everyone to agree on the problem statement. You need to ensure your definition is accurate, complete, and defensible. Note dissenting views in your CSW and explain why you maintained your definition.

5.3 Root Cause Analysis

5.3.1 The 5 Whys Method

The simplest root cause tool. Start with the problem and ask "Why?" five times. Each answer becomes the input for the next question.

Example — ECCD teacher shortage:

Round	Question	Answer
Why 1	Why do 42% of daycare centers lack qualified ECCD teachers?	Because qualified applicants do not apply for daycare teacher positions in BARMM.
Why 2	Why don't qualified applicants apply?	Because the salary (SG 8-9) is below the market rate for ECCD-qualified graduates.
Why 3	Why is the salary below market rate?	Because daycare teacher positions are classified under local government plantilla at entry-level salary grades.
Why 4	Why hasn't the classification been updated?	Because LGUs lack the fiscal capacity to reclassify positions, and BARMM has not legislated salary supplements for ECCD teachers.
Why 5	Why hasn't BARMM legislated salary supplements?	Because no CSW has been produced to present the evidence and recommend legislative action.

The 5 Whys reveal that the root cause is not "lack of teachers" (a symptom) but a structural salary and classification problem that requires legislative and fiscal intervention.

5.3.2 Fishbone (Ishikawa) Diagram

For complex problems with multiple contributing factors, use a fishbone diagram. Organize causes into categories:

Category	Possible Causes
People	Skills gaps, staffing shortages, resistance to change

Category	Possible Causes
Process	Unclear procedures, bureaucratic delays, lack of coordination
Policy	Outdated regulations, conflicting mandates, missing guidelines
Resources	Budget constraints, infrastructure gaps, equipment shortages
Environment	Political dynamics, geographic challenges, conflict-affected areas
Data	Missing baseline data, unreliable metrics, no monitoring system

Map your specific CSW issue onto these categories. Identify which category contains the dominant causes. This directs your research (Step 3) and option generation (Step 4).

> **TIP:** Use both tools. Start with the 5 Whys for a quick linear analysis. Then use the fish-bone to check whether you missed lateral causes. The combination covers both depth and breadth.

5.4 Assessing Consequences of Inaction

Your problem statement describes what is wrong. Now describe what happens if nothing changes.

Decision-makers need to understand the cost of inaction. This is your "so what?" section. If the consequences are minor, the CSW may not be a priority. If the consequences are severe, the urgency becomes clear.

Structure your consequences assessment:

Timeframe	Consequence	Impact
Short-term (0-12 months)	What happens immediately if the problem continues?	Quantify: affected persons, budget cost, compliance risk
Medium-term (1-3 years)	How does the problem compound over time?	Quantify: cumulative impact, opportunity cost
Long-term (3+ years)	What systemic damage results from sustained inaction?	Describe: institutional reputation, development trajectory, public trust

Example:

> **Short-term:** 62,000 children continue receiving substandard ECCD. BARMM fails to meet RA 12199 compliance deadline (June 2026). Risk of national government intervention.
>
> **Medium-term:** A generation of BARMM children enters elementary school with weaker cognitive and social foundations. Achievement gaps between BARMM and national averages widen. Estimated 15-point gap in National Achievement Test scores by 2028.
>
> **Long-term:** Human capital deficit undermines BDP Goal 2 (Social Development). BARMM's education competitiveness declines. Economic productivity losses estimated at PHP 8-12 billion annually by 2035 (based on World Bank human capital index methodology).

5.5 Establishing SMART Objectives

With the problem defined and consequences established, set objectives for your CSW effort.

SMART criteria:

Criterion	What It Means	Example
Specific	Names exactly what you aim to achieve	Increase the proportion of BARMM daycare centers with qualified ECCD teachers
Measurable	Includes a quantifiable target	From 58% to 80%
Achievable	Realistic given constraints	Requires legislative action + MFBM budget allocation
Relevant	Aligned with mandate and BDP	BOL Article VI, Section 13; BDP Goal 2, Strategy 2.3
Time-bound	Has a deadline	By the end of fiscal year 2028

Combined SMART objective:

> Increase the proportion of BARMM public daycare centers with qualified ECCD teachers from 58% to 80% by FY 2028, through a combination of salary supplements, training programs, and scholarship incentives, aligned with BOL Article VI, Section 13 and BDP Goal 2, Strategy 2.3.

Write 2-3 SMART objectives per CSW output. One primary objective and 1-2 secondary objectives. Do not write more than three — focus matters more than comprehensiveness.

5.6 Documenting the Problem Statement

Your Step 2 output is a **documented problem statement** that includes:

1. **The problem statement** (specific, measurable, aligned)
2. **Stakeholder deliberation summary** (who was consulted, what they said)
3. **Root cause analysis** (5 Whys and/or fishbone findings)
4. **Consequences of inaction** (short, medium, long-term)
5. **SMART objectives** (2-3 objectives with targets and timelines)

This document becomes Section 3 of your General CSW (GN03), Section I-III of your Legislative Briefer, or the Problem Statement chapter of your Policy Recommendation. It anchors everything that follows.

> **CAUTION:** Do not change your problem statement once you begin Step 3 (Research) unless new evidence forces a revision. Scope creep in the problem definition is the most common cause of CSW projects that run over deadline. If the problem changes, restart the problem definition process. Do not patch.

5.7 Why This Step Matters — Consequences of Skipping

When you skip problem definition:

You solve the wrong problem. Without a clear statement, your research wanders. You collect data on symptoms instead of causes. Your options address surface issues while the root cause persists.

You waste resources. A well-defined problem narrows the research scope (Step 3) and focuses option generation (Step 4). An undefined problem means researching everything and exploring options that do not connect.

Decision-makers cannot act. A CSW output without a clear problem statement leaves the decision-maker asking: "What exactly am I deciding?" They cannot approve what they do not understand.

Stakeholders lose trust. When you present a recommendation that does not match their experience of the problem, stakeholders disengage. They see the CSW as disconnected from reality.

Real BARMM example of skipping Step 2:

A Parliament committee staff member was asked to prepare a briefer on health service delivery in island municipalities. The staff member skipped problem definition and went directly to research. The resulting briefer presented 40 pages of health statistics, facility inventories, and program descriptions. But it never stated what problem the committee should address.

The Committee Chairperson asked: "So what is the problem, and what should we do about it?"

The staff member could not answer. The briefer was shelved. Two months of work produced zero actionable output.

A single paragraph — "Island municipalities in BARMM have 1 physician per 47,000 population versus the DOH standard of 1:20,000, resulting in maternal mortality rates 3.2 times the national average" — would have given the committee the clarity it needed.

Chapter Summary

- A problem statement must be specific, measurable, and aligned with your office's mandate
- Use the problem statement template to structure your articulation
- Deliberate with stakeholders to validate and refine the problem definition
- Apply the 5 Whys and fishbone diagram to identify root causes, not symptoms
- Assess consequences of inaction across short, medium, and long-term timeframes
- Set 2-3 SMART objectives with quantified targets and deadlines
- Document the complete problem statement as the anchor for all subsequent ADDRESS IT steps
- Skipping this step produces unfocused research, irrelevant options, and CSW that decision-makers cannot act on

Next: Chapter 6 guides you through Step 3 — Research Needed Information — where you build the evidence base for your analysis.

Back to Table of Contents

06

Step 3: Research Needed Information (R)

Your problem is defined. Your objectives are set. Now you need evidence. Step 3 is where you build the factual foundation that supports your analysis, options, and recommendation.

Weak research produces weak CSW. If your data is outdated, your sources are unreliable, or your analysis is superficial, the decision-maker cannot trust your conclusions. The quality of your research determines the credibility of everything that follows.

6.1 Developing a Research Plan

Do not start researching randomly. Start with a plan. A research plan answers four questions:

Question	Output
What do I need to know?	List of specific research questions
Where will I find it?	Sources mapped to each question
How will I collect it?	Methods for each source (document review, interview, data request)
When will I finish?	Timeline with milestones

Research Plan Template

Research Question	Source	Method	Responsible	Due Date	Status
What is the current number of qualified ECCD teachers in BARMM?	MBHTE Human Resource Division	Data request (formal letter)	Lead analyst	Day 3	
What salary grades apply to daycare teachers?	CSC / LGU plantilla records	Document review	Research assistant	Day 2	
What are best practices for ECCD	Academic journals,	Literature review	Lead analyst	Day 5	

Research Question	Source	Method	Responsible	Due Date	Status
teacher recruitment in similar contexts?	UNICEF reports				

The plan keeps your research focused. Without it, you spend three days reading interesting but irrelevant material while the deadline approaches.

> **TIP:** Allocate no more than 30-40% of your total CSW timeline to research. If you have 10 working days, spend 3-4 on research. The remaining time goes to options analysis, writing, review, and revision. Research that consumes the entire timeline leaves no time to think.

6.2 Identifying and Evaluating Sources

6.2.1 Government Data (PSA-BARMM, MFBM, Implementing Agencies)

Government data is your primary source for BARMM CSW. It has institutional authority and is what decision-makers expect to see.

Source	What It Provides	How to Access
PSA-BARMM	Population, poverty incidence, employment, demographic data	PSA regional office, PSA website (psa.gov.ph)
MFBM	Budget data, expenditure program, financial statements	Formal data request to MFBM planning division
Bangsamoro Expenditure Program (BEP)	Agency-level budget allocations by year	Committee on Finance and Budget records
COA Annual Audit Reports	Audit findings, financial observations, compliance issues	COA BARMM office, COA website
Implementing agencies	Program data, performance indicators, accomplishment reports	Direct coordination or formal request
BDP 2023-2028	Development targets, baseline indicators, strategic framework	Published document (available in BARMM offices)

6.2.2 Academic and Policy Research

Academic sources add analytical depth and credibility.

Where to look:

- **Google Scholar** (scholar.google.com) — Free access to academic papers, many with full text
- **Philippine Institute for Development Studies (PIDS)** — Philippine policy research
- **World Bank Open Knowledge Repository** — Development data and research, often with Philippines-specific reports

- **UNICEF, UNDP, ADB** — Sector-specific reports on education, governance, and development
- **University of the Philippines** — Philippine governance and public administration research

6.2.3 Stakeholder Inputs

Stakeholder consultation produces primary data that government statistics cannot capture: lived experience, operational realities, and political context.

Methods for gathering stakeholder inputs:

Method	When to Use	Sample Size	Time Required
Key informant interviews	When you need depth from specific experts	5-15 individuals	1-2 hours per interview
Focus group discussions	When you need community perspectives	8-12 per group, 2-4 groups	1.5-2 hours per group
Surveys	When you need quantitative data from a large group	50+ respondents	1-3 weeks for design, deployment, analysis
Written consultation	When stakeholders are geographically dispersed	Variable	1-2 weeks for responses

> **CAUTION:** Evaluate every source for credibility, timeliness, and relevance. A 2018 report on BARMM education may be outdated if significant reforms occurred after 2019 (BOL ratification). Government data from before the transition period may not reflect current BARMM realities. Always check the publication date and note limitations.

6.3 Conducting a Literature Review

A literature review is not a reading list. It is a structured synthesis of existing knowledge on your topic.

How to conduct a literature review for CSW:

Step 1: Search systematically. Use 3-5 search terms derived from your problem statement. Search at least three databases or sources. Document your search terms and results.

Step 2: Screen for relevance. Read abstracts and executive summaries first. Select 10-20 most relevant sources for full review.

Step 3: Extract key findings. For each source, record:

Element	What to Record
Citation	Author, title, year, source
Key findings	2-3 main conclusions relevant to your problem
Methodology	How the research was conducted
Limitations	What the research did not cover
Relevance	How it applies to your specific BARMM context

Step 4: Synthesize. Do not present sources one by one ("Smith (2023) says... Jones (2024) says..."). Organize by theme. What do the sources collectively say about root causes? About effective interventions? About risks?

Step 5: Identify gaps. What has not been studied? What BARMM-specific data is missing? These gaps may require primary data collection (Section 6.4) or may be flagged as limitations in your CSW.

6.4 Gathering Primary Data

When existing sources do not answer your research questions, you need primary data.

6.4.1 Surveys, Interviews, Focus Groups

Surveys produce quantitative data from large groups. Use when you need statistics: satisfaction rates, awareness levels, resource counts.

- Design clear, unambiguous questions
- Keep surveys under 20 minutes
- Use validated scales when available
- Pre-test with 5-10 respondents before full deployment

Interviews produce qualitative data with depth. Use when you need explanations, narratives, and expert judgment.

- Prepare a semi-structured interview guide (5-10 questions)
- Allow follow-up questions based on responses
- Record with permission or take detailed notes
- Transcribe key points within 24 hours

Focus groups produce group perspectives and surface disagreements. Use when you need to understand how different stakeholders view the same issue.

- Recruit 8-12 participants per group
- Use a skilled facilitator (not the lead analyst)
- Prepare a discussion guide with 4-6 open-ended questions
- Record and document group dynamics, not just content

6.4.2 Ethical Guidelines and Data Privacy

All primary data collection must comply with ethical standards and RA 10173 (Data Privacy Act).

Mandatory requirements:

- **Informed consent** — Participants must know the purpose, how data will be used, and their right to decline

- **Confidentiality** — Protect participant identities unless they consent to attribution
- **Voluntary participation** — No coercion, no incentives that compromise voluntary choice
- **Data security** — Store collected data securely; limit access to the research team
- **Cultural sensitivity** — Respect Bangsamoro cultural norms, gender protocols, and community protocols when conducting fieldwork

> **BANGSAMORO NOTE:** When collecting data in communities, respect local protocols. Introduce yourself through the barangay chair or community leader. In predominantly Muslim communities, be mindful of gender dynamics during interviews and focus groups. Offer separate-gender sessions when appropriate. Schedule around prayer times.

6.5 Analyzing and Synthesizing Information

Data collection is not research. Analysis is.

Analytical Methods for CSW

Data Type	Analytical Method	When to Use
Quantitative	Descriptive statistics (averages, percentages, trends)	Budget data, population figures, coverage rates
Quantitative	Variance analysis (compare actual vs. target)	Budget execution, KPI achievement
Quantitative	Trend analysis (multi-year comparison)	Budget trends, enrollment trends, staffing trends
Qualitative	Thematic analysis (identify recurring themes)	Interview transcripts, consultation notes
Qualitative	Content analysis (categorize document contents)	Policy documents, legislation, reports
Mixed	Triangulation (cross-validate findings across sources)	Any CSW — strengthen conclusions by showing multiple sources agree

Synthesis Framework

Organize your findings around your research questions, not your sources:

Research Question	Finding	Sources	Confidence Level
How many qualified ECCD teachers does BARMM have?	1,738 out of 2,985 positions filled by qualified teachers (58.2%)	MBHTE HR data, Dec 2025	High — verified government data
What is the primary barrier to recruitment?	Salary competitiveness (SG 8-9 vs. private sector SG 11-13 equivalent)	Interviews with 12 MBHTE regional directors; CSC salary schedule	Moderate — qualitative triangulated with salary data

6.6 Identifying Best Practices

Look for models that have solved similar problems in comparable contexts.

Hierarchy of relevance for best practices:

1. **Within BARMM** — Solutions already working in other BARMM agencies or LGUs (most directly applicable)
2. **Within the Philippines** — National government or other LGU approaches
3. **Southeast Asian countries** — Similar governance and development contexts
4. **International** — Global best practices (least directly transferable but can inform design)

When presenting best practices in your CSW, always assess **transferability**. A program that works in Metro Manila may fail in island municipalities of BARMM. Explain what would need to adapt, not just what worked elsewhere.

6.7 Documenting and Validating Findings

Documentation Standards

Your research section must be traceable. Every claim needs a source. Every figure needs a citation.

Citation format for CSW:

- Government documents: Agency name, document title, year. Example: "MBHTE, Status Report on ECCD Implementation, 2025"
- Legal provisions: Full citation. Example: "BOL, Article VI, Section 13"
- Academic sources: Author (Year). Example: "Santos (2024)"
- Interview data: Position title and date (protect identity when needed). Example: "Interview with MBHTE Regional Director, January 15, 2026"

Validation

Before finalizing your research findings, validate with subject matter experts.

Validation questions:

1. Are the data accurate and current?
2. Are the sources credible?
3. Are there findings that contradict other evidence?
4. Have I missed any critical source?
5. Are my interpretations reasonable, or am I reaching beyond the evidence?

Share draft findings with 2-3 knowledgeable colleagues. Ask them to challenge your conclusions. Revise where warranted.

6.8 Why This Step Matters — Consequences of Skipping

When you skip or rush research:

Your options float on air. Without evidence, your recommendations are opinions. Decision-makers can and should reject opinions presented as analysis.

You miss critical information. A law you did not find, a data point you did not check, a stakeholder perspective you did not seek — any of these can invalidate your entire CSW.

Your credibility collapses. If the decision-maker discovers an error in your data, they question everything else in the document. One wrong number taints 30 pages of analysis.

You repeat past mistakes. Without reviewing what has been tried before, you may recommend an approach that already failed. Best practice review prevents reinventing broken wheels.

Real BARMM example of skipping Step 3:

A legislative staff member prepared a budget briefer for a ministry's FY 2026 request. The briefer recommended approving the full budget. During deliberation, an MP asked about the ministry's utilization rate for the previous year. The staff member had not checked.

The actual utilization rate was 47% — meaning the ministry spent less than half its FY 2025 budget. The committee reduced the FY 2026 allocation by 30% and questioned the staff member's competence.

A 30-minute review of COA expenditure data would have surfaced the utilization rate in Step 3. The briefer would have addressed it proactively, perhaps recommending conditional approval with a utilization improvement plan. Instead, the staff member's credibility and the office's reputation suffered permanent damage.

Chapter Summary

- Develop a research plan before starting. Map research questions to sources, methods, and deadlines.
- Prioritize government data (PSA, MFBM, implementing agencies) for BARMM CSW.

- Supplement with academic research, stakeholder inputs, and best practices.
- Conduct literature reviews thematically, not source by source.
- Follow ethical guidelines and data privacy requirements for primary data collection.
- Analyze and synthesize findings organized by research questions, not by source.
- Document every finding with traceable citations.
- Validate findings with subject matter experts before finalizing.
- Skipping research produces opinion-based CSW, missed critical data, credibility damage, and repeated failures.

Next: Chapter 7 shows you how to transform your research findings into evaluated options through Step 4 — Explore Options.

Back to Table of Contents

07

Step 4: Explore Options (E)

You defined the problem. You gathered evidence. Now you must generate solutions, evaluate them against consistent criteria, and recommend the best one. This is the step where analysis becomes advice.

Decision-makers do not want a single option presented as the only way forward. They want to see that you considered alternatives, weighed trade-offs, and arrived at a recommendation through systematic evaluation. One option is a directive. Three options are a decision.

7.1 Generating Options (Minimum 2-3)

How to Generate Options

Start broad, then narrow. Your initial list should include 4-6 possibilities. After evaluation, you will present the top 2-3 to the decision-maker.

Methods for generating options:

Method	How It Works	Best For
Brainstorming	Generate as many ideas as possible without filtering. Quantity first, quality later.	Creative or novel problems
Benchmarking	Examine how other organizations solved similar problems. Adapt their approaches.	Problems with known solutions elsewhere
Incremental vs. transformational	Generate one option that modifies the current approach and another that replaces it entirely.	Situations where the status quo has some value
Stakeholder-driven	Ask each stakeholder group what solution they prefer. Map the range of preferences.	Politically sensitive issues
Resource-based	Design options around different resource levels: minimal, moderate, maximum investment.	Budget-constrained environments

Rules for Option Generation

1. **Minimum two options, target three.** One option is not a choice. Two options create a binary. Three options give the decision-maker genuine discretion.
2. **No strawmen.** Every option must be genuinely viable. Do not include an obviously bad option to make your preferred option look good. Decision-makers see through this.
3. **Include the status quo.** If doing nothing is a real possibility, present it as Option A. Show its consequences alongside the action options.
4. **Vary the approach, not just the scale.** “Build 100 schools” and “Build 200 schools” are not two options. They are one option at two scales. Real alternatives differ in approach: “Build schools” vs. “Subsidize private providers” vs. “Mobile learning units.”

> **TIP:** If you cannot generate at least two genuinely different options, you have not researched deeply enough. Return to Step 3 and look for alternative approaches, different models, or different intervention points.

7.2 Evaluation Criteria

Evaluate every option against the same five criteria. This ensures consistency and transparency.

7.2.1 Feasibility

Can you actually do this?

Feasibility Dimension	Questions to Ask
Technical	Does BARMM have the technical capacity to implement?
Administrative	Are the institutional mechanisms in place?
Political	Is there sufficient political support? Will Parliament or the executive approve?
Legal	Is the option authorized under the BOL, BAAs, and applicable laws?
Timeline	Can it be implemented within the required timeframe?

7.2.2 Effectiveness

Does it solve the problem?

- How much of the problem does this option address?
- Does it target root causes or symptoms?
- What is the projected impact on the measurable indicators in your problem statement?
- How confident are you in the projected outcome?

7.2.3 Efficiency

Does it make good use of resources?

- What is the total cost (direct and indirect)?
- What is the cost per beneficiary or per unit of outcome?

- Does it leverage existing infrastructure and personnel, or does it require new investment?
- Are there economies of scale?

7.2.4 Sustainability

Will the results last?

- Can the option be maintained after initial funding ends?
- Does it build institutional capacity or create dependency on external support?
- Is it resilient to political changes, leadership transitions, and budget fluctuations?
- Does it create self-reinforcing mechanisms?

7.2.5 Alignment with Organizational Goals

Does it fit BARMM's direction?

- How does this option advance the BDP 2023-2028?
- Does it align with the 12-point priority agenda?
- Is it consistent with the BOL's vision for the Bangsamoro?
- Does it support moral governance principles?

7.3 Impact Analysis

For each option, assess the impact on different stakeholder groups and dimensions.

Impact Analysis Matrix:

Impact Dimension	Option A	Option B	Option C
Beneficiaries	Who benefits? How many? How much?		
Affected communities	Who is disadvantaged? What mitigation exists?		
Budget	Total cost, funding source, fiscal sustainability		
Personnel	Staffing requirements, training needs		
Legal/compliance	Regulatory requirements, COA exposure		
Political	Level of support, potential opposition		
Timeline	Implementation duration, milestones		
Risk	Key risks and probability of occurrence		

> **BANGSAMORO NOTE:** Impact analysis in BARMM should always include assessment of effects on **peace and security**, **indigenous peoples** (where applicable), **gender equity**, and **Shari'ah compliance** (where applicable). These are not optional add-ons. The BOL and BDP require attention to these dimensions.

7.4 Cost-Benefit Analysis

For options with significant financial implications, conduct a structured CBA.

Basic CBA Framework for CSW

Element	Option A	Option B	Option C
Direct costs			
Personnel Services (PS)			
Maintenance & Other Operating Expenses (MOOE)			
Capital Outlay (CO)			
Total cost			
Quantifiable benefits			
Revenue generated or saved			
Service delivery improvement (quantified)			
Efficiency gains (time, resources)			
Non-quantifiable benefits			
Institutional capacity built			
Public trust strengthened			
BDP alignment achieved			
Benefit-Cost Ratio	Benefits / Costs		
Payback Period	When benefits exceed costs		

> **CAUTION:** Do not fabricate precision. If you cannot reliably estimate a benefit, state it qualitatively rather than assigning a made-up number. “Improved public trust” is an honest non-quantifiable benefit. “PHP 50 million in public trust value” is fiction.

When CBA Is Not Appropriate

Not every CSW requires formal CBA. Cost-benefit analysis works best for:

- Capital projects and infrastructure
- Program expansions with clear budget implications
- Options that differ significantly in cost

CBA is less useful for:

- Legal compliance questions (you must comply regardless of cost)
- Ethical or human rights issues
- Situations where benefits are primarily intangible

In these cases, use the five evaluation criteria (Section 7.2) without forcing a numerical CBA.

7.5 Prioritizing and Ranking Options

Use an **Options Evaluation Matrix** to score each option against the five criteria.

Options Evaluation Matrix

Criterion	Weight	Option A	Option B	Option C
Feasibility	25%			
Effectiveness	30%			
Efficiency	15%			
Sustainability	15%			
Alignment	15%			
Weighted Total	100%			
Rank				

Scoring scale: 1 (Very Low) to 5 (Very High)

Weighted score = Score x Weight. Sum weighted scores for each option. Highest total is the top-ranked option.

Assigning weights: The default weights above work for most CSW. Adjust based on the decision-maker's priorities. If the Chief Minister has emphasized fiscal discipline, increase the Efficiency weight. If the issue is a legal compliance matter, increase Feasibility.

Example — ECCD Teacher Shortage options:

Criterion	Weight	A: Salary Supplement	B: Bridging Program	C: Combined (A+B)
Feasibility	25%	3 (requires BAA)	4 (admin order)	3
Effectiveness	30%	4 (addresses root cause)	3 (addresses one factor)	5 (addresses both)

Criterion	Weight	A: Salary Supplement	B: Bridging Program	C: Combined (A+B)
Efficiency	15%	3 (recurring cost)	4 (one-time + recurring)	3
Sustainability	15%	4 (if legislated)	3 (needs annual funding)	4
Alignment	15%	5 (BDP Goal 2)	4 (BDP Goal 2)	5
Weighted Total	100%	**3.7**	**3.6**	**4.2**
Rank		2	3	**1**

7.6 Validating with Stakeholders

Before finalizing your recommendation, test your top option(s) with key stakeholders.

What to validate:

Question	Stakeholder
Is this option technically feasible?	Subject matter experts, implementing agency
Will this option have unintended consequences?	Affected communities, frontline staff
Can we fund this?	MFBM, budget officer
Will this pass Parliament (if legislative action is needed)?	Committee staff, political advisors
Does this comply with applicable laws?	Legal counsel

Stakeholder validation is not asking for permission. It is a reality check. If a key stakeholder identifies a fatal flaw in your top option, better to find out now than after the decision-maker approves it.

7.7 Preparing for Recommendation

Your Step 4 output feeds directly into Step 5 (Submit). Before moving forward, confirm:

- ☐ At least 2-3 genuine options were generated (no strawmen)
- ☐ Each option was evaluated against all five criteria
- ☐ Impact analysis covered all relevant dimensions
- ☐ CBA was conducted where appropriate
- ☐ Options are ranked with a clear top recommendation
- ☐ Key stakeholders validated the top option
- ☐ The rationale for the recommendation is documented with evidence

Prepare a clear recommendation statement:

> Based on the evaluation of three options against five criteria (feasibility, effectiveness, efficiency, sustainability, and alignment), **Option C (Combined Salary Supplement and Bridging Program)** is recommended. It scored highest overall (4.2 out of 5.0), primarily due to its effectiveness in addressing both root causes of the ECCD teacher shortage (salary competitiveness and qualification gaps). The estimated total cost is PHP 340 million over three years, funded from the BARMM block grant education allocation. Implementation requires a new BAA authorizing salary supplements and an administrative order establishing the bridging program.

7.8 Why This Step Matters — Consequences of Skipping

When you skip option exploration:

You default to the first idea. Without generating alternatives, you recommend whatever occurred to you first. First ideas are rarely the best ideas. They reflect your biases, not the evidence.

The decision-maker has no choice. A single option forces a yes-or-no decision. The decision-maker cannot weigh trade-offs, adjust scope, or combine elements from different approaches.

You miss superior solutions. Brainstorming, benchmarking, and stakeholder input often produce options you would never have conceived alone. Skipping this step means missing them.

Your recommendation lacks justification. "We recommend this because it is the best option" means nothing if you have not shown what the other options were and why they ranked lower.

Real BARMM example of skipping Step 4:

A ministry prepared a project proposal for a regional skills training center. The proposal presented one option: construct a new training center in Cotabato City at a cost of PHP 850 million. MFBM rejected the proposal, noting that the ministry had not explored alternatives.

When forced to explore options, the ministry discovered three alternatives: (A) renovating an existing underutilized government building (PHP 120 million), (B) partnering with private TESDA-accredited institutions through a subsidy model (PHP 45 million per year), and (C) a hybrid approach combining a smaller new facility with private partnerships (PHP 280 million plus PHP 20 million per year).

Option C was eventually approved. It cost 67% less than the original proposal and achieved broader geographic coverage through the private partnership component. The initial single-option approach would have either been rejected entirely or approved at a cost three times higher than necessary.

Chapter Summary

- Generate at least 2-3 genuine options. No strawmen. Include the status quo if relevant.
- Evaluate every option against five criteria: feasibility, effectiveness, efficiency, sustainability, and alignment.
- Conduct impact analysis across stakeholder groups and key dimensions.
- Perform cost-benefit analysis for options with significant financial implications.
- Rank options using a weighted evaluation matrix. Document the scoring and rationale.
- Validate the top option with key stakeholders before finalizing.
- Prepare a clear recommendation statement with evidence-based justification.
- Skipping this step leads to first-idea defaults, unjustified recommendations, and missed superior solutions.

Next: Chapter 8 covers Step 5 — Submit Proposal or Report — where you package your analysis into a decision-ready document.

Back to Table of Contents

08

Step 5: Submit Proposal or Report (SS)

Your analysis is complete. Your options are evaluated. Your recommendation is ready. Now you must package everything into a document the decision-maker can act on.

This is where most CSW outputs fail or succeed. Brilliant analysis buried in poor writing is useless. A clear, well-structured report with a compelling executive summary and a crisp call to action is what moves decisions forward.

8.1 Developing the Report Structure

Choose your CSW type (Chapter 3) and follow its section structure. Regardless of type, every CSW output shares a common architecture:

Component	Purpose	Write When
Executive Summary	One-page overview of the entire document	Write LAST
Background/ Context	What the assignment is and why it matters	From Step 1 notes
Problem Statement	What exactly needs to be addressed	From Step 2 output
Research Findings	What the evidence shows	From Step 3 output
Options Analysis	What alternatives exist and how they compare	From Step 4 output
Recommendation	What you advise and why	From Step 4 conclusion
Implementation Plan	How the recommendation would be carried out	Write now
Call to Action	What the decision-maker should approve	Write now

Assemble the document in this order, but write the **Executive Summary last**. You cannot summarize what you have not yet written.

8.2 Writing the Executive Summary (Write Last)

The Executive Summary is the most-read part of your CSW. Many decision-makers read only this section before deciding whether to read further or sign immediately.

Rules for Executive Summaries

1. **One page maximum.** If it exceeds one page, it is no longer a summary.
2. **Write it last.** After every other section is complete.
3. **Cover four elements:**
4. The problem (1-2 sentences)
5. The recommended solution (2-3 sentences)
6. The expected benefits (1-2 sentences)
7. The action requested from the decision-maker (1 sentence)
8. **No jargon.** Write as if the reader has no prior knowledge of the issue.
9. **No new information.** Every fact in the Executive Summary must appear in the body.

Example Executive Summary:

> An estimated 42% of public daycare centers in BARMM operate without qualified ECCD teachers, affecting approximately 62,000 children aged 3-5. This non-compliance with RA 12199 standards threatens BARMM's education outcomes and BDP Goal 2 targets.
>
> This report recommends a combined approach: (1) a salary supplement authorized by new legislation to close the 40% gap between daycare teacher salaries and market rates, and (2) a teacher bridging program through administrative order to upgrade existing teachers' qualifications within 24 months. The estimated cost is PHP 340 million over three years.
>
> Implementation of this recommendation is expected to increase qualified-teacher coverage from 58% to 80% by FY 2028, directly advancing BDP Strategy 2.3 (Expanding Access to Quality Education).
>
> **Action requested:** Approval to prepare the legislative proposal (salary supplement BAA) and the administrative order (bridging program) for submission to the Committee on Education.

8.3 Presenting the Problem and Research Findings

This section consolidates your Step 2 and Step 3 outputs. Do not copy-paste your research notes. Present findings in a structured narrative that builds the case for action.

Presentation Guidelines

Lead with the most important finding. Do not build suspense. State the key fact first, then support it with detail.

Use visual aids. Tables, charts, and graphs communicate data faster than paragraphs.

Visual Aid	Use For
Tables	Comparisons, multi-year data, criteria matrices
Bar charts	Budget comparisons, performance metrics
Trend lines	Multi-year trends, progress tracking
Maps	Geographic distribution of services or problems
Flowcharts	Process descriptions, decision trees

Cite every data point. Decision-makers need to know where your numbers come from. Uncited data is unverified data.

Distinguish facts from analysis. “The utilization rate is 47%” is a fact. “The low utilization rate suggests weak absorptive capacity” is analysis. Present facts first, then your analytical interpretation.

8.4 Discussing Options Explored

Present all options you evaluated, not just the recommended one. Show the decision-maker the full landscape of possibilities.

For each option, include:

1. **Brief description** — What the option is and how it works
2. **Evaluation results** — Scores against the five criteria
3. **Key advantages** — Why this option has merit
4. **Key disadvantages** — Why this option falls short
5. **Why it ranked where it did** — Clear reasoning for its position

Include the Options Evaluation Matrix (Section 7.5) as a summary table.

> **TIP:** Be fair to all options. If you present one option with enthusiasm and the others with disdain, the decision-maker will suspect bias. Present all options objectively. Let the criteria-based evaluation carry your argument.

8.5 Presenting the Recommendation

State your recommendation clearly and directly.

Structure:

1. **The recommendation** — One paragraph stating exactly what you recommend
2. **Why this option** — Reference its evaluation scores and key advantages
3. **How it addresses the problem** — Connect directly to your problem statement and SMART objectives
4. **Expected outcomes** — Quantified benefits aligned with BDP targets
5. **Key risks** — What could go wrong and how to mitigate it

Do not hedge. “It is suggested that perhaps the ministry might consider…” is weak. “This report recommends that the Ministry adopt Option C” is direct.

8.6 Developing the Implementation Plan

A recommendation without an implementation plan is a wish. Decision-makers need to see how the approved option will translate into action.

Implementation Plan Components

Component	Content
Actions	Specific steps to implement the recommendation
Timeline	Phased schedule with start dates, milestones, and completion dates
Responsible parties	Who leads each action (by position, not individual name)
Resources required	Budget, personnel, equipment, infrastructure
Dependencies	What must happen before each action can start
Risks and mitigation	What could go wrong and how you will handle it
Monitoring indicators	How you will track progress

Implementation Plan Template:

Phase	Action	Timeline	Responsible	Resources	Risk/Mitigation
Phase 1	Draft BAA for salary supplements	Month 1-2	Legislative staff	Staff time	Risk: delayed committee calendar. Mitigation: early coordination with committee chair.
Phase 2	Issue administrative order for bridging program	Month 2-3	MBHTE Planning	Staff time, legal review	Risk: legal challenge. Mitigation: pre-clearance with legal counsel.

Phase	Action	Timeline	Responsible	Resources	Risk/Mitigation
Phase 3	Deploy bridging training to priority provinces	Month 4-12	MBHTE, TEIs	PHP 85M (Year 1)	Risk: low enrollment. Mitigation: mandatory participation for unqualified daycare teachers.

8.7 The Call to Action

End your CSW with a clear, specific call to action. Tell the decision-maker exactly what you are asking them to approve.

Good call to action:

> **Recommended action:** Approve the preparation and filing of a BAA establishing salary supplements for ECCD daycare teachers (estimated annual cost: PHP 95 million from the block grant education allocation), and the issuance of an administrative order establishing the ECCD Teacher Bridging Program.

Weak call to action:

> We hope the committee will consider these recommendations and take appropriate action as deemed fit.

The first version tells the decision-maker what to sign. The second leaves them guessing.

8.8 Review and Refinement

Before sending your CSW to your supervisor, review it yourself. Then have a peer review it.

Self-Review Checklist

- ☐ Does the Executive Summary capture the full document in one page?
- ☐ Is the problem statement specific, measurable, and aligned?
- ☐ Are all data points cited with sources?
- ☐ Are there at least 2-3 genuine options (no strawmen)?
- ☐ Is the evaluation matrix consistent (same criteria, same scoring)?
- ☐ Does the recommendation follow logically from the analysis?
- ☐ Is the implementation plan actionable (specific steps, dates, owners)?
- ☐ Is the call to action clear and specific?
- ☐ Are all BOL, BAA, and legal citations accurate?
- ☐ Are names and titles of officials correct?
- ☐ Is the document free of grammatical errors and typos?
- ☐ Does it follow the appropriate CSW template format?

Peer Review

Ask a colleague to read your CSW and answer three questions:

1. "After reading this, do you understand the problem?"
2. "Do you find the recommendation convincing?"
3. "Is anything confusing, missing, or unconvincing?"

Incorporate feedback before transmitting to your supervisor.

8.9 Obtaining Supervisor Review and Clearance

Your direct supervisor reviews and clears the CSW before it reaches the decision-maker. This is not a rubber stamp. It is a quality gate.

What supervisors check:

Check	What They Look For
Accuracy	Are the facts correct? Are citations verified?
Completeness	Are all required sections filled? Are there gaps?
Alignment	Does this align with the office's position and priorities?
Sensitivity	Are there political, cultural, or security sensitivities the analyst may have missed?
Quality	Is the writing clear, professional, and decision-ready?

Engage your supervisor, do not surprise them. Brief them informally before submitting the formal draft. If they have concerns about your direction, it is better to hear them early than after you have written 30 pages.

After supervisor clearance, attach the **Transmittal Memorandum** (Section 8.11) and submit through the appropriate channel.

8.10 Submitting to the Decision-Maker

When the CSW reaches the decision-maker, be prepared to:

1. **Present in person** if asked. Have a 5-minute verbal summary ready. Do not read the document aloud. Highlight the problem, the recommendation, and the action requested.
2. **Answer questions.** The decision-maker may challenge your data, question your options, or probe your reasoning. Know your material thoroughly.
3. **Accept the decision.** The decision-maker may approve, disapprove, or modify your recommendation. All three outcomes are valid. CSW is complete when the decision-maker can decide — the specific decision is theirs.
4. **Follow up.** After submission, confirm receipt. Check whether additional information is needed. Track the decision timeline.

8.11 The Transmittal Memorandum

Every CSW output is submitted with a **Transmittal Memorandum**. This is the cover memo that introduces the document and requests action.

Transmittal Memorandum Format

Element	Content
TO	Decision-maker (name and title)
FROM	Analyst/author (name and title), endorsed by supervisor
DATE	Submission date
SUBJECT	CSW title and reference number
Purpose	One-sentence statement of why you are submitting this document
Summary	2-3 sentence summary of the key finding and recommendation
Action Requested	What the decision-maker should approve or decide
Enclosure	The CSW document (with page count)
Prepared by	Analyst's name, position, and signature
Reviewed by	Supervisor's name, position, and signature

The transmittal memo is not a summary of the entire CSW. It is a routing document. Keep it to one page.

> **TIP:** The transmittal memorandum is your quality gate. Your supervisor's signature on the transmittal means they have reviewed and endorsed the CSW. Do not submit without it. An unsigned transmittal signals that no supervisor has cleared the work.

8.12 Why This Step Matters — Consequences of Skipping

When you submit poorly:

The decision-maker cannot act. If the CSW is disorganized, the executive summary is missing, or the call to action is vague, the document sits on the desk. No decision is made. The problem persists.

Your analysis is wasted. You may have done excellent research and option evaluation, but if the presentation is unclear, the decision-maker never sees the quality of your work.

Your supervisor's reputation suffers. The supervisor who endorsed your CSW is associated with its quality. Poor submission reflects on your entire office.

The decision is delayed. If the CSW needs revision after submission, you lose the decision window. For legislative briefers, this may mean missing the committee deliberation date entirely.

Real BARMM example of submitting poorly:

A budget briefer was transmitted to the Committee on Finance and Budget for an agency's FY 2026 review. The briefer was 35 pages long but lacked an executive summary. The budget comparison section (BB06) contained accurate data but no variance analysis — just raw numbers. The recommendation section (BB12) said "further study is recommended" without specifying what to study or what action the committee should take.

The Committee Chairperson returned the briefer with a single note: "Finished work only, please."

The analyst had spent three weeks on research (Step 3). The problem was not research quality. It was output quality. The data was there. The analysis was there. The packaging was not.

Chapter Summary

- Structure your CSW output using the appropriate template. Follow the section order.
- Write the Executive Summary last. One page. Four elements: problem, recommendation, benefits, action requested.

- Present research findings with visual aids and citations. Lead with the most important finding.
- Show all options evaluated, not just the recommended one. Be fair and objective.
- State your recommendation directly. No hedging.
- Include a specific, actionable implementation plan with timeline, responsibilities, and resources.
- End with a clear call to action. Tell the decision-maker exactly what to approve.
- Self-review, peer-review, and supervisor clearance are mandatory quality gates.
- Submit with a Transmittal Memorandum signed by your supervisor.
- Skipping this step means wasted analysis, delayed decisions, and damaged credibility.

Next: Chapter 9 covers Step 6 — Sustain Efforts to Implement — what happens after the decision-maker says yes.

Back to Table of Contents

09

Step 6: Sustain Efforts to Implement (S)

The decision-maker approved your recommendation. The hard part is over, right? Wrong. Approval is the beginning of implementation, not the end of your responsibility.

Step 6 ensures that approved solutions do not die on paper. Approved projects without sustained implementation effort become audit findings, not achievements. Your job extends beyond the signature.

9.1 Keeping Approval and Stakeholder Support

Approval is not permanent. Decision-makers face competing priorities. Stakeholders have short attention spans. Political dynamics shift. If you disappear after approval, your project risks losing its champion.

How to maintain support:

- **Regular progress updates.** Send brief monthly reports to the decision-maker. Include what was accomplished, what is on track, and what needs attention.
- **Quick wins.** Deliver visible results early. If your ECCD recommendation was approved, announce the first training cohort within 60 days. Early achievements build momentum.
- **Escalate promptly.** When obstacles arise, report them immediately with proposed solutions. Do not wait for the next scheduled update. Surprises erode trust.
- **Align with the decision-maker's priorities.** Frame progress updates in terms of BDP goals, legislative mandates, and political commitments. Connect your project to what the decision-maker cares about.

> **TIP:** The same CSW skills you used to prepare the recommendation apply to implementation reporting. Each progress report is a mini-CSW: status (context), challenges (problem), proposed adjustments (options), and recommended next steps (recommendation).

9.2 Mobilizing Resources

Approved recommendations need resources: people, money, equipment, and authority. Mobilize them proactively.

Resource Mobilization Checklist

Resource	Actions	Responsible
Budget	Prepare budget request or realignment memo. Coordinate with finance division. Ensure allotment is obligated.	Finance officer, project lead
Personnel	Identify staff assignments. Request detail orders if needed. Hire additional staff if authorized.	HR, division chief
Equipment/ Infrastructure	Prepare procurement requests. Check existing inventory before purchasing.	Admin, procurement
Authority	Obtain special orders, travel orders, delegation memos. Ensure implementing staff have clear authorization.	Head of office
Partnerships	Formalize MOAs/MOUs with partner agencies. Set coordination schedules.	Project lead

Common mobilization failures:

- Budget is approved but not obligated before the fiscal year ends — funds revert
- Personnel are not formally assigned — no one takes ownership
- Equipment procurement starts too late — implementation waits months for supplies
- Partner agencies are not formally engaged — coordination is ad hoc and unreliable

> **CAUTION:** In BARMM, budget obligation and disbursement rates are persistent challenges. Many agencies have approved budgets that they cannot spend fast enough. Build realistic disbursement timelines into your implementation plan. Do not assume that approval equals availability.

9.3 Developing Detailed Action Plans

Your Step 5 implementation plan was strategic. Now develop operational-level action plans.

Detailed Action Plan Template

Week	Activity	Output/Deliverable	Responsible	Status
Week 1-2	Draft administrative order for bridging program	Draft AO for legal review	Project lead	
Week 3-4	Coordinate with TEIs for bridging curriculum	Signed MOAs with 3 TEIs	Education specialist	
Week 5-8	Design training modules	12 training modules reviewed and approved	Curriculum team	
Week 9-12	Deploy first cohort in Maguindanao del Sur	200 teachers enrolled	Regional coordinators	

Action Plan Principles

1. **Break big tasks into weekly deliverables.** "Train 1,000 teachers" is a project. "Enroll 200 teachers in Cohort 1 by Week 12" is an action.
2. **Assign by position, not just by name.** People transfer. If you assign to a position, the action survives personnel changes.
3. **Define deliverables, not just activities.** "Conduct training" is an activity. "200 teachers complete 40-hour bridging program and receive certificates" is a deliverable.
4. **Build in buffer time.** BARMM operations face logistical challenges — travel to island municipalities, security coordination in conflict-affected areas, weather disruptions during monsoon season. Build 20-30% buffer into your timeline.

9.4 Training and Capacity Building

Most recommendations require people to do something new. Training ensures they can.

When Training Is Needed

Situation	Training Response
New process or system introduced	Orientation training for all affected staff
New skills required (e.g., data collection, financial analysis)	Technical training with hands-on practice
New policy or regulation to implement	Compliance briefing with Q&A
Technology deployment	User training with practice sessions and help desk

Training Design Principles for BARMM

- **Keep sessions short.** 2-3 day trainings are optimal. Staff in BARMM offices cannot afford week-long absences.
- **Use local languages.** Training materials in English are fine for reading. Facilitation in Filipino or local languages improves comprehension.
- **Include writeshop components.** Participants should produce an actual output during training, not just listen to lectures.
- **Provide post-training support.** A training without follow-up produces no lasting change. Schedule 30-day and 90-day check-ins.

9.5 Monitoring Progress

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

Define KPIs at the start of implementation, not after. Each KPI answers: "How will we know if this is working?"

KPI Design Criteria:

Criterion	Requirement
Relevant	Directly measures the intended outcome
Measurable	Can be quantified with available data
Timely	Can be measured at regular intervals
Attributable	Changes in the indicator can be linked to your project
Practical	Data collection is feasible given resources

Example KPIs for the ECCD recommendation:

KPI	Baseline	Target	Frequency	Data Source
% of daycare centers with qualified teachers	58%	80%	Quarterly	MBHTE HR data
Teachers enrolled in bridging program	0	1,000	Monthly	TEI enrollment records
Teachers completing bridging program	0	800 (80% completion)	Per cohort	TEI graduation records
Salary supplement disbursements released on time	N/A	100%	Quarterly	MFBM financial reports

Progress Reporting

Establish a reporting rhythm:

Report Type	Frequency	Audience	Content
Flash report	Weekly	Project team	Activities completed, immediate issues
Progress report	Monthly	Supervisor, stakeholders	KPI status, milestones achieved, challenges, next steps
Quarterly review	Quarterly	Decision-maker	Comprehensive progress against targets, budget execution, risk update

> **BANGSAMORO NOTE:** Progress reports in BARMM should include budget utilization rates. Low utilization is a recurring concern across BARMM agencies. If your project is disbursing on schedule, highlight it. If utilization is lagging, explain why and present a catch-up plan.

9.6 Engaging Stakeholders Throughout Implementation

Stakeholder engagement does not end when the CSW is approved. Stakeholders need ongoing communication during implementation.

Stakeholder Engagement Plan

Stakeholder	Engagement Method	Frequency	Key Messages
Decision-maker	Written progress reports	Monthly	KPI status, key achievements, decisions needed
Implementing staff	Team meetings, coordination calls	Weekly	Assignments, issues, support needed
Partner agencies	Coordination meetings	Bi-monthly	Shared milestones, coordination issues
Beneficiary communities	Community updates, feedback sessions	Quarterly	Program progress, how to participate, how to provide feedback
COA	Documentation and records	As required	Compliance with procurement, financial management requirements

Managing Resistance

Not everyone will support implementation. Resistance is normal. Manage it:

1. **Identify resistance early.** Who is pushing back? What is their concern?
2. **Listen first.** Resistance often contains useful information. The concern may reveal a genuine implementation problem.
3. **Address legitimate concerns.** If a stakeholder raises a valid issue, adjust the plan. Flexibility is a strength, not a weakness.
4. **Escalate when needed.** If resistance is obstructive and not based on legitimate concerns, escalate to the decision-maker.

9.7 Why This Step Matters — Consequences of Skipping

When you skip sustained implementation:

Approved solutions die on paper. The CSW sits in a file. No resources are mobilized. No actions are taken. The problem persists despite having a documented, approved solution.

Resources are wasted. If partial implementation occurs without coordination, money is spent without results. COA will flag this.

Stakeholder trust erodes. Communities who were consulted during Step 2 and told their input mattered see no change. They stop participating in future consultations.

The organization loses credibility. Decision-makers who approve recommendations that are never implemented stop taking CSW seriously. They learn that approval is meaningless.

Real BARMM example of skipping Step 6:

A ministry approved a comprehensive social protection assessment and response plan in 2024. The CSW was thorough: 45 pages of analysis, three options evaluated, a detailed implementation plan. The minister signed it.

No one was assigned to implement it.

The project lead assumed the approval would trigger automatic action. It did not. The budget was not requested in the next BEP cycle. No staff were detailed to the project. Partner LGUs were not notified.

Eighteen months later, the same minister asked for a status report. Staff had to explain that the approved plan was never implemented. The minister's response: "Then what was the point of all that analysis?"

The analysis was excellent. The implementation was zero. Step 6 was the missing link.

Chapter Summary

- Approval is the beginning of implementation, not the end of CSW responsibility
- Maintain decision-maker support through regular progress updates and quick wins

- Mobilize resources proactively: budget, personnel, equipment, authority, partnerships
- Develop operational action plans with weekly deliverables and assigned responsibilities
- Provide training and capacity building when implementation requires new skills
- Monitor progress with defined KPIs, regular reporting, and quarterly reviews
- Engage stakeholders throughout implementation, including managing resistance
- Skipping this step means approved solutions die on paper, resources are wasted, and organizational credibility erodes

Next: Chapter 10 covers Step 7 — Iterate and Improve — closing the CSW cycle through monitoring, evaluation, and continuous improvement.

Back to Table of Contents

10

Step 7: Iterate and Improve (IT)

The CSW process does not end with implementation. Conditions change. New data emerges. Results deviate from projections. Step 7 closes the loop. It transforms CSW from a one-time exercise into a cycle of continuous improvement.

If you stop at Step 6, you never learn whether your recommendation actually worked. You never capture what you did right or wrong. You never improve.

10.1 Monitoring and Evaluation Framework

The Difference Between Monitoring and Evaluation

Activity	What It Does	When	Who
Monitoring	Tracks implementation progress against planned milestones and KPIs	Ongoing (weekly, monthly, quarterly)	Project team, supervisor
Evaluation	Assesses whether the implementation achieved its intended outcomes and impact	At defined intervals (mid-term, end-of-project)	Project team with external input

Monitoring tells you: “Are we doing what we planned?”

Evaluation tells you: “Did what we planned actually solve the problem?”

Designing Your M&E Framework

Component	Content	Example
Objective	What the M&E framework measures	Track progress toward 80% qualified-teacher coverage
Indicators	Specific metrics with baseline and targets	Qualified-teacher ratio: 58% baseline, 80% target
Data sources	Where indicator data comes from	MBHTE HR database, TEI enrollment records
Collection schedule	When data is gathered	Quarterly
	How data is interpreted	Trend analysis, variance from target

Component	Content	Example
Analysis method		
Reporting	Who receives the analysis and when	Decision-maker (quarterly), stakeholders (semi-annually)
Decision triggers	What results require action	Below 65% by Month 12 triggers plan revision

BARMM-Specific M&E Considerations

- **Data availability:** Many BARMM agencies have limited data systems. Plan for manual data collection where automated systems do not exist.
- **Geographic challenges:** Monitoring projects in island and conflict-affected areas requires additional time and logistics. Budget for travel and coordination.
- **COA compliance:** Maintain M&E documentation that satisfies COA audit requirements. Financial records, progress reports, and accomplishment reports should be organized for audit readiness.

10.2 Collecting Feedback

Feedback comes from four sources. Collect from all of them.

Source	What They Tell You	Method
Beneficiaries	Whether the solution actually improves their situation	Surveys, community forums, complaint mechanisms
Implementers	What operational challenges they face	Team debriefs, after-action reviews
Decision-makers	Whether the solution meets their expectations	Periodic check-ins, progress meetings
External observers	How the solution is perceived and whether it produces unintended effects	Media monitoring, CSO feedback, academic assessments

Feedback Collection Methods

Rapid feedback surveys. Short (5-10 question) surveys deployed quarterly to beneficiaries. Use mobile-based tools when possible (Google Forms, KoboToolbox).

After-action reviews (AARs). Structured team discussions after each major milestone. Four questions: (1) What did we plan to do? (2) What actually happened? (3) Why was there a difference? (4) What should we do differently next time?

Complaint and feedback mechanisms. Establish a clear channel for beneficiaries to report problems. This could be a hotline, a feedback box at service delivery points, or a designated contact person.

> **TIP:** After-action reviews are the simplest and most effective feedback tool. Hold a 30-minute AAR after every major deliverable. Write down the lessons. Over time, the accumulated AARs become your institutional knowledge base.

10.3 Analyzing Performance Data

Raw data is not insight. You need to analyze performance data to extract actionable conclusions.

Performance Analysis Questions

Question	Analysis Method	Action Trigger
Are we on track against targets?	Compare actual vs. planned KPIs	If more than 15% below target: revise plan
Is the rate of progress sufficient?	Trend analysis (extrapolate current rate to deadline)	If projected end-state misses target: accelerate or adjust
Which components are working? Which are not?	Disaggregated analysis by component, region, or cohort	Redirect resources from strong to weak components
Are there unintended consequences?	Stakeholder feedback analysis, incident reports	If negative effects emerge: mitigate or modify approach
Is the budget being utilized effectively?	Obligation and disbursement rate analysis	If utilization is below 50% at midpoint: investigate and resolve

Presenting Performance Data

When reporting performance to the decision-maker, use the **stoplight format:**

Indicator	Target	Actual	Status
Qualified teachers	70% (Year 1)	65%	**YELLOW** — slightly behind, on track with acceleration
Bridging enrollees	500	480	**GREEN** — 96% of target
Budget utilization	40% by Q2	28%	**RED** — significantly behind, corrective action needed

Green = On track (90%+ of target). Yellow = At risk (70-89%). Red = Off track (<70%).

10.4 Identifying Areas for Improvement

Performance analysis reveals what needs to change. Categorize improvements by type:

Type	Description	Example
Process improvement	Fix how things are done	Streamline the TEI enrollment process to reduce waiting time from 3 weeks to 5 days
Design improvement	Change what is being done	Add a stipend component to the bridging program to reduce dropout
Scale adjustment	Modify the scope	Expand from 3 provinces to 5, or narrow focus to the highest-need municipalities
Resource reallocation	Redirect budget or personnel	Shift underspent capital outlay funds to supplement MOOE for training costs
Timeline adjustment	Change the schedule	Extend Phase 2 by 3 months to accommodate delayed procurement

Prioritize improvements by **impact on the target** and **feasibility of implementation**. Fix high-impact, easy-to-implement issues first.

10.5 Iterating and Refining

Iteration is not failure. It is the CSW process working as designed.

When to Iterate

Signal	Response
KPIs are consistently below target	Analyze root causes. Adjust the implementation approach.
Stakeholder feedback reveals unintended negative effects	Modify the design to mitigate. Consult affected stakeholders.
New information changes the problem landscape	Reassess whether the original problem statement still holds.
External conditions shift (political, economic, legal)	Evaluate whether the original recommendation is still valid under new conditions.
A better solution becomes available	Assess whether switching solutions is feasible and cost-effective.

Iteration Protocol

1. **Document the issue.** What is going wrong, and what evidence supports this assessment?
2. **Analyze the cause.** Is the problem in the design, the implementation, the resources, or the external environment?
3. **Develop an adjustment.** Propose a specific modification to address the cause.
4. **Consult stakeholders.** Validate the adjustment with implementers and beneficiaries.
5. **Approve the change.** Secure decision-maker approval for significant modifications.
6. **Implement and monitor.** Deploy the adjustment and track whether it resolves the issue.
7. **Document the lesson.** Record what happened, what you changed, and what resulted.

> **BANGSAMORO NOTE:** BARMM is a transitional government building institutions from the ground up. Iteration is not a sign of weakness — it is essential. First-generation programs and policies will always need refinement. The BDP itself acknowledges that iterative improvement is the path to institutional maturity.

10.6 Documenting Lessons Learned

Lessons learned are organizational assets. If you do not document them, the same mistakes repeat across offices and generations of staff.

Lessons Learned Template

Element	Content
Project/Initiative	Name of the CSW output and the approved recommendation
Lesson	What was learned (stated as a principle, not a narrative)
Context	What happened that produced this lesson
Evidence	Data, observations, or feedback supporting the lesson
Recommendation	How future CSW or implementation should apply this lesson
Applicable to	Which offices, CSW types, or contexts this lesson applies to

Example:

> **Lesson:** Bridging programs for in-service teachers require stipend support to achieve acceptable completion rates.
>
> **Context:** The ECCD Teacher Bridging Program in Phase 1 (without stipends) achieved only 62% completion versus the 80% target. Exit surveys showed 78% of dropouts cited inability to cover travel and accommodation costs.
>
> **Evidence:** Phase 2 (with PHP 5,000/month stipend) achieved 91% completion. The stipend cost added 12% to the program budget but increased output by 47%.
>
> **Recommendation:** All future teacher training programs should include stipend provisions. Budget planning should allocate 10-15% of training costs for participant support.
>
> **Applicable to:** MBHTE, MILG, MSSD — any agency running training programs for in-service government workers.

Sharing Lessons

- File lessons learned reports in your office's knowledge management system

- Share across agencies during inter-agency coordination meetings
- Include relevant lessons in future CSW outputs when addressing similar problems
- Brief incoming staff during turnover to transfer institutional knowledge

10.7 Restarting the CSW Cycle When Necessary

Step 7 can loop back to Step 1. This happens when:

- **The problem changes.** The original issue is resolved, but a new problem emerges from implementation.
- **The environment shifts.** A change in law, leadership, or budget renders the current approach obsolete.
- **The evaluation reveals fundamental design flaws.** Minor adjustments are insufficient; a fresh analysis is needed.
- **Success creates new requirements.** The program works and should be scaled, expanded, or institutionalized through legislation.

When you restart, bring your lessons learned from the previous cycle. The new CSW should build on what was learned, not start from zero.

The ADDRESS IT cycle:

```
Step 1 (Analyze) --> Step 2 (Define) --> Step 3 (Research) --> Step 4
(Explore)
     ^                                                                |
     |                                                                v
Step 7 (Iterate) <-- Step 6 (Sustain) <-- Step 5 (Submit)
```

The cycle continues as long as the problem exists, the institution operates, and conditions evolve. CSW is not a project. It is a practice.

10.8 Why This Step Matters — Consequences of Skipping

When you skip iteration:

Solutions become obsolete. Conditions change. A recommendation that was optimal in 2026 may be suboptimal by 2028. Without iteration, outdated solutions persist.

Mistakes repeat. Without documenting lessons learned, the next analyst working on a similar problem will make the same errors. Organizational learning stalls.

Resources are wasted on ineffective programs. Without evaluation, underperforming programs continue to consume budget. Effective programs receive no additional support because their success is undocumented.

The CSW culture erodes. If staff see that no one checks whether CSW recommendations actually worked, they lose motivation to produce quality work. The standard slips from "decision-ready" to "good enough to submit."

Real BARMM example of skipping Step 7:

A scholarship program was launched based on thorough CSW analysis. The program awarded 5,000 scholarships per year. After three years, the program had disbursed PHP 750 million. No evaluation was conducted.

An external audit in the fourth year revealed that only 2,100 of 15,000 total scholars (14%) had graduated. The rest had dropped out, become academically delinquent, or were untraceable. The program was investing PHP 50,000 per scholar per year, but 86% of that investment yielded no completed degree.

If Step 7 had been active, the first-year completion data (which showed a 35% dropout rate) would have triggered an investigation and intervention. Root causes — inadequate academic preparation, lack of mentoring, housing insecurity — would have been identified and addressed. The program could have been redesigned after Year 1 instead of running at 14% effectiveness for four years.

The total cost of not iterating: approximately PHP 500 million in scholarships that produced no graduates.

Chapter Summary

- Monitoring tracks implementation progress; evaluation assesses whether outcomes were achieved
- Design an M&E framework at the start of implementation with clear indicators, data sources, and decision triggers
- Collect feedback from beneficiaries, implementers, decision-makers, and external observers
- Analyze performance data using variance analysis and the stoplight format
- Identify and prioritize improvements by impact and feasibility
- Iterate through a structured protocol: document, analyze, adjust, consult, approve, implement, record
- Document lessons learned and share them across the organization
- Restart the CSW cycle when the problem changes, the environment shifts, or success creates new requirements
- Skipping this step means outdated solutions, repeated mistakes, wasted resources, and eroding CSW culture

Next: Chapter 11 applies the ADDRESS IT framework to the specific context of Parliamentary committee work.

Back to Table of Contents

11

CSW for Parliamentary Committees

If you work in the Bangsamoro Parliament, your CSW directly shapes legislation. A committee deliberation is only as good as the briefer that informs it. An oversight inquiry is only as incisive as the research behind it. A budget review is only as thorough as the analysis your staff produces.

This chapter applies the ADDRESS IT framework to the four main CSW outputs of parliamentary committee work: legislative briefers, committee reports, oversight CSW, and budget deliberation briefers.

11.1 How the 13-Section Legislative Briefer Maps to ADDRESS IT

The 13-section legislative briefer is the standard CSW output for bill analysis. Each section maps directly to an ADDRESS IT step.

Section	Content	ADDRESS IT Step	What the Step Requires
I. Overview	Bill title, author, committee referral, status	**Step 1** (Analyze)	Identify the assignment: what bill, who authored it, where it stands
II. Brief Description	Summary of key provisions	**Step 1** (Analyze)	Understand what the bill does
III. Previous Proceedings	Legislative history, related measures	**Step 2** (Define)	Define what problem the bill addresses; what has been tried before
IV. Implementing Agency	Agency responsible for implementation	**Step 1** (Analyze)	Identify stakeholders responsible for execution
V. Appropriations Needed	Estimated budget impact	**Step 3** (Research)	Research the fiscal cost of the bill
VI. Objects of Expenditure	Specific budget line items	**Step 3** (Research)	Research where the money will be spent
VII. Source of Funds	Where funding comes from	**Step 3** (Research)	Research available funding mechanisms
VIII. Sectoral Analysis	Impact on specific sectors	**Step 3** (Research)	Research who benefits and who is affected

Section	Content	ADDRESS IT Step	What the Step Requires
IX. BOL Alignment	Constitutional and BOL consistency	**Steps 1+3**	Review legal framework; verify constitutional basis
X. Parliamentary Strategy	Recommended approach for committee action	**Step 4** (Explore)	Explore options for how the committee should proceed
XI. Proposed Amendments	Specific textual amendments	**Step 4** (Explore)	Explore options for improving the bill's text
XII. Recommended Vote	Approval, deferral, or disapproval	**Step 5** (Submit)	Submit your recommendation to the committee
XIII. Strategic Intelligence	Broader political and policy context	**Steps 4+5**	Provide context for decision-making

How to Complete Each Section

Sections I-III (ADDRESS IT Steps 1-2): Establish the context and define the problem. Do not analyze yet. Describe the bill, its history, and the problem it aims to solve.

Sections IV-IX (ADDRESS IT Step 3): Research. This is the analytical core. Investigate the budget impact, sectoral effects, legal consistency, and implementation feasibility. Cite every data point.

Sections X-XII (ADDRESS IT Steps 4-5): Evaluate and recommend. What are the committee's options? What amendments improve the bill? Should the committee approve, defer, or disapprove?

Section XIII (Context for decision): Provide the intelligence the committee needs to act wisely. This includes stakeholder positions, political dynamics, timing considerations, media attention, and potential controversies.

> **TIP:** Spend 50% of your time on Sections IV-IX (research). Spend 30% on Sections X-XIII (analysis and recommendation). Spend 20% on Sections I-III (context). The research sections carry the analytical weight.

11.2 Committee-Specific CSW

Each standing committee has its own policy domain. Your CSW must reflect the committee's jurisdiction and expertise.

Committee Context Factors

Factor	What to Consider
Committee mandate	What is the committee's subject matter jurisdiction under the Rules of the BTA Parliament?
Committee composition	Who are the members? What are their policy interests and district constituencies?
Pending legislation	What bills are referred to the committee? What is the hearing calendar?
Previous committee actions	What positions has the committee taken on similar issues?
Inter-committee dynamics	Does the bill require referral to another committee (e.g., finance, legal)?

Adapting CSW for Different Committee Types

Legislative committees (Education, Health, etc.) — Focus on policy substance, sectoral impact, implementation feasibility, and alignment with BDP goals.

Committee on Finance and Budget — Focus on fiscal impact, budget adequacy, fund sourcing, and COA compliance. Use the Budget Briefer (BB) format.

Committee on Rules — Focus on procedural matters: order of business, priority legislation, session calendar.

Committee on Legal Affairs — Focus on constitutional consistency, BOL alignment, legal drafting quality, and potential judicial challenges.

Oversight committees — Focus on implementation status, performance against targets, agency compliance, and corrective actions needed.

11.3 Committee Reports and Oversight CSW

When a committee completes its deliberation on a bill or conducts an oversight investigation, it produces a **Committee Report** for plenary consideration.

Committee Report Structure

Section	Content
I. Introduction	The referral, committee jurisdiction, and scope of the report
II. Proceedings	Summary of committee hearings, resource persons who testified, key issues raised
III. Analysis	The committee's assessment of the bill or issue (draws from the legislative briefer)
IV. Amendments Adopted	Specific textual amendments agreed upon during committee deliberation
V. Recommendation	The committee's recommendation to plenary: approve, approve with amendments, defer, disapprove
VI. Signatures	Committee Chairperson and members who concur

The committee report is the committee's CSW to plenary. It must be decision-ready. Members of Parliament who are not on the committee will read this report to decide their vote. Give them everything they need.

Oversight CSW

Oversight is the Parliament's power to monitor how laws and programs are implemented. Oversight CSW differs from legislative CSW:

Legislative CSW	Oversight CSW
Analyzes proposed legislation	Analyzes implementation of existing legislation
Forward-looking: what should we enact?	Backward-looking: did the law achieve its purpose?

Legislative CSW	Oversight CSW
Primary output: legislative briefer	Primary output: oversight report
Decision: approve/amend/ disapprove the bill	Decision: commend/require corrective action/legislate amendments

Oversight CSW follows ADDRESS IT:

1. **Analyze** — What law or program are you overseeing? What is the implementation status?
2. **Define** — What implementation problems have emerged?
3. **Research** — What do the data show? What are the COA findings? What do implementing agencies report?
4. **Explore** — What corrective options exist? Legislative amendment? Budget adjustment? Administrative reform?
5. **Submit** — Present oversight findings and recommendations to the committee
6. **Sustain** — Track whether corrective actions are implemented
7. **Iterate** — Schedule follow-up oversight to verify improvement

11.4 Interpellation Preparation as CSW

When an MP prepares to interpellate (question a minister or agency head during plenary or committee session), the staff must produce a specific type of CSW: **interpellation preparation material**.

Interpellation Prep Structure

Component	Content
Background brief	Issue summary, relevant data, legal context
Key questions	10-15 prepared questions, sequenced to build a line of inquiry
Expected answers	Anticipated responses from the agency head
Follow-up questions	Questions to ask based on expected answers
Documentary evidence	Exhibits, data tables, COA findings to cite during interpellation
Desired outcome	What the MP wants to achieve through the interpellation

> **TIP:** Good interpellation questions are specific, evidence-based, and sequenced. Start with factual questions the respondent must answer ("What was your agency's utilization rate in FY 2025?"). Build toward analytical questions ("Why is 47% acceptable when the national average is 78%?"). End with action-oriented questions ("What corrective measures will you implement, and by when?").

11.5 Budget Deliberation Briefers

During BARMM's annual appropriation process, each agency's budget is reviewed by the Committee on Finance and Budget. Staff produce **Budget Briefers** (BB01-BB13) for each agency under the committee's review calendar.

Budget Deliberation Timeline

Phase	Activity	CSW Required
Pre-deliberation	Agency submits BEP to Parliament	Staff prepares BB01-BB13 for assigned agencies
Committee hearing	Agency presents budget; committee questions	Staff provides real-time research support
Post-hearing analysis	Committee reviews testimony and data	Staff updates briefer with hearing findings
Committee markup	Committee adjusts budget figures	Staff prepares options for budget adjustments
Report to plenary	Committee reports recommended budget to plenary	Staff prepares committee report on budget

Budget Deliberation CSW Best Practices

1. **Start with BB06 (Budget Comparison).** The multi-year comparison reveals trends, variances, and anomalies that drive the rest of the analysis.
2. **Flag utilization rates.** If an agency consistently underspends, question why before recommending the same or higher allocation.
3. **Connect budget to BDP.** Show which BDP goals each PPAS advances. Flag budget items that do not connect to any BDP priority.
4. **Prepare questions for the MP.** Based on your analysis, draft specific questions the committee member should ask during the hearing. Include the expected answer and the follow-up.
5. **Update after the hearing.** The agency's testimony may change your analysis. Update the briefer with new information before the markup session.

> **BANGSAMORO NOTE:** BARMM budget deliberation occurs under BAA 84 (Budget System Act). Familiarize yourself with the budget cycle, timeline requirements, and classification system (Tier 1 vs. Tier 2 PPAS) before preparing budget briefers. Cross-reference with the latest Budget Call memorandum from MFBM.

Chapter Summary

- The 13-section legislative briefer maps directly to ADDRESS IT steps 1-5
- Committee CSW must reflect the specific committee's jurisdiction, composition, and policy domain
- Committee reports are the committee's CSW to plenary — they must be decision-ready
- Oversight CSW follows ADDRESS IT but focuses on implementation assessment rather than legislative analysis
- Interpellation preparation is a specialized CSW product requiring sequenced questions and evidence
- Budget deliberation briefers (BB01-BB13) follow a structured timeline from pre-deliberation through plenary report
- All parliamentary CSW exists to serve one purpose: enabling informed collective decision-making by Members of Parliament

Next: Chapter 12 applies the ADDRESS IT framework to MOA decision-making contexts — budget requests, project proposals, procurement, and personnel actions.

Back to Table of Contents

12

CSW for MOA Decision-Making

If you work in a Ministry, Office, or Agency (MOA), your CSW supports executive decision-making. Ministers, directors, and division chiefs need staff work that is accurate, actionable, and audit-ready. The stakes are different from Parliament — you are dealing with budgets, procurement, personnel, and program delivery where every decision has a COA trail.

This chapter covers the five most common MOA CSW contexts: budget requests, project proposals, personnel actions, procurement justifications, and the approval hierarchies that govern them.

12.1 Budget Requests and Financial Proposals

Every peso your agency spends starts with a budget request. CSW for budget requests must justify the allocation with data, connect it to mandates, and survive both MFBM review and parliamentary scrutiny.

Budget Request CSW Structure

Section	Content	ADDRESS IT Step
Agency mandate and function	Legal basis for the agency's existence and operations	Step 1
Program/project description	What the budget will fund (PPAs)	Steps 1-2
Performance data	Accomplishments against prior-year targets	Step 3
Budget breakdown	PS, MOOE, CO by line item	Step 3
Multi-year comparison	Current vs. previous years with variance analysis	Step 3
BDP alignment	Which development goals the budget advances	Step 4
Justification	Why this amount, why now, what happens without it	Steps 4-5
Utilization plan	How funds will be obligated and disbursed by quarter	Step 6

Common Budget CSW Mistakes

Mistake	Consequence	Prevention
Requesting more than prior year without justification	MFBM flags for reduction	Explain every variance exceeding 10%
Ignoring prior-year utilization rates	Committee reduces allocation based on underspending	Address utilization proactively with improvement plan
Vague PPAS descriptions	Budget cannot be attributed to specific outcomes	Write measurable PPAS with clear KPIs
Missing legal basis	Budget items appear unauthorized	Cite the BOL provision, BAA, or administrative order
No BDP alignment	Budget appears disconnected from regional priorities	Map every major PPAS to a BDP goal

> **CAUTION:** COA audits start with the budget. Every peso must be traceable from appropriation to obligation to disbursement to output. Your budget CSW creates the paper trail. If the CSW is sloppy, the audit trail is compromised.

12.2 Project Proposals and Program Design

MOA staff produce project proposals (PP template, Chapter 3) for new initiatives. These proposals undergo multiple approval layers before implementation.

Project Proposal Approval Chain

Level	Reviewer	What They Check
1	Division Chief	Technical accuracy, feasibility
2	Director/Undersecretary	Alignment with agency priorities
3	Minister	Strategic fit, resource availability
4	MFBM (for budget implications)	Fiscal impact, fund availability
5	Parliament (for legislative appropriation)	BDP alignment, public value

Your CSW must survive every level. Each reviewer looks at different things. The Division Chief cares about whether the numbers are right. The Minister cares about whether this advances their priorities. Parliament cares about whether this serves the Bangsamoro people.

Program Design Elements

Good project proposals include:

Element	Standard
Theory of change	Clear logic: If we do [intervention], then [output] will lead to [outcome] because [evidence]
Beneficiary identification	Specific target population with selection criteria
Geographic scope	Where the project will operate (municipalities, barangays)
Implementation structure	Who does what, reporting lines, coordination mechanisms

Element	Standard
Sustainability plan	What happens when project funding ends
Risk register	Identified risks with probability, impact, and mitigation
M&E plan	How outcomes will be measured and reported

> **TIP:** Decision-makers in BARMM approve dozens of project proposals each year. Make yours stand out by leading with the problem and the evidence, not the solution. A proposal that demonstrates a deep understanding of the problem is more convincing than one that jumps straight to activities and budgets.

12.3 Personnel Actions and Administrative Matters

Personnel CSW is highly regulated. The Civil Service Commission (CSC), BARMM HR guidelines, and BAA 17 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code) set strict requirements for hiring, promotion, reassignment, and disciplinary actions.

Personnel Action CSW Requirements

Action	CSW Must Include	Key Regulations
New hiring	Position vacancy, qualification standards, comparative assessment, selection board recommendation	CSC MC 14/2018, BAA 17
Promotion	Performance evaluation, qualification match, selection board recommendation	CSC promotion rules, BARMM HR guidelines
Reassignment/ detail	Justification, duration, receiving office consent, no diminution of rank or pay	CSC rules on reassignment
Reorganization	Rationalization study, staffing pattern, transition plan, affected personnel list	DBM/MFBM guidelines
Disciplinary action	Statement of charges, evidence, due process documentation, recommended penalty	CSC Revised Rules on Administrative Cases

Critical Personnel CSW Rules

1. **Document everything.** Every step of the personnel action must be on paper. Missing documentation is the number one cause of COA disallowance for personnel expenses.
2. **Follow the selection board process.** Hiring and promotion decisions must go through the Personnel Selection Board. Shortcuts invite appeals and legal challenges.
3. **Verify qualification standards.** Do not recommend someone who does not meet CSC minimum qualification standards. This includes education, experience, training, and eligibility.

4. **Calculate financial impact.** Every personnel action has a cost: salary differential, benefits, allowances. Include these calculations in your CSW.

> **CAUTION:** Personnel CSW errors have personal liability implications. If a hiring is disallowed by COA, the approving officer and the certifying officer may be required to refund the salary paid. Get the CSW right.

12.4 Procurement Justifications

BARMM procurement follows RA 9184 (Government Procurement Reform Act) as adapted for autonomous region operations. Procurement CSW justifies why the agency needs to buy something, what specifications are required, and how the procurement will be conducted.

Procurement CSW Elements

Element	Content
Purchase request	What is being procured, quantity, specifications
Market survey	Price comparison from at least three suppliers
Budget certification	Confirmation that funds are available
Technical specifications	Detailed specs that are non-restrictive (do not favor a single supplier)
Procurement method	Why the chosen method (competitive bidding, shopping, direct contracting) is appropriate
Approved Budget for the Contract (ABC)	Maximum price the agency will pay
End-user certification	Confirmation from the requesting unit

Procurement CSW Common Errors

Error	COA/BAC Response
Technical specs written to favor one supplier	BAC rejects; potential administrative charges
No market survey or outdated prices	ABC may be inflated; audit finding
Wrong procurement method for the amount	Procurement is void; items must be returned or regularized

Error	COA/BAC Response
Missing budget certification	Procurement cannot proceed; delays implementation
Splitting purchases to avoid competitive bidding	Violation of RA 9184; subject to sanctions

> **BANGSAMORO NOTE:** BARMM procurement can involve additional coordination with the BARMM Bids and Awards Committee (BAC) structure. Ensure your CSW identifies the correct BAC (agency-level or centralized) and follows the approved procurement plan. Late procurement requests that fall outside the Annual Procurement Plan (APP) require justification and amendment.

12.5 Approval Hierarchies and Transmittal Procedures

MOA CSW flows through a defined hierarchy. Understanding this chain is critical for correct transmittal.

Typical MOA Approval Chain

Level	Position	Authority	Transmittal Format
Preparing officer	Analyst/Staff	Drafts the CSW	Internal draft with initials
Reviewing officer	Section/Unit Head	Checks technical accuracy	Review notation on draft
Recommending officer	Division Chief	Recommends approval	Signed endorsement memo
Approving authority	Director/ Minister	Makes the decision	Signed approval on transmittal memo

Transmittal Rules

1. **Use the transmittal memorandum.** Every CSW reaching the approving authority must have a transmittal memo (Chapter 8, Section 8.11).
2. **Include all endorsements.** The reviewing and recommending officers' signatures must appear on the transmittal chain.
3. **Route through the correct channels.** Do not skip levels. A CSW that goes directly from the analyst to the minister bypasses quality gates and may be returned.
4. **Track transmittal dates.** Log when the CSW was submitted, to whom, and the expected decision date. Follow up if no action is taken within the standard period.

When to Use Different Transmittal Channels

Urgency	Channel	Appropriate For
Routine	Standard memo with physical routing	Regular CSW, reports, recommendations

Urgency	Channel	Appropriate For
Urgent	Expedited routing with “URGENT” marking	Time-sensitive decisions, deadlines
Confidential	Sealed envelope, hand-delivered	Personnel actions, legal opinions, sensitive matters
For information	Email or electronic copy	Progress reports, data updates, status reports

12.6 Working with COA Requirements

The Commission on Audit (COA) reviews all government expenditures. Your CSW must anticipate COA requirements and build compliance into the documentation.

COA Documentation Standards

COA Requirement	How Your CSW Addresses It
Legal basis for expenditure	Cite the BOL provision, BAA, or administrative order authorizing the action
Approved budget	Reference the allotment and its SARO/NCA number
Proper authorization	Include all required signatures in the approval chain
Supporting documents	Attach all evidence: quotations, contracts, performance data, accomplishment reports
Value for money	Demonstrate that the expenditure achieves results proportionate to cost
Compliance with procurement law	Document the procurement method, bidding process, and BAC resolution

Proactive Audit Readiness

Do not wait for COA to ask for documents. Organize them from the start.

Audit-ready file structure:

1. Transmittal memorandum with approval
2. CSW document (complete, with all sections filled)
3. Legal basis documentation
4. Budget certification and allotment documents
5. Procurement documents (if applicable)
6. Implementation records (progress reports, accomplishment reports)
7. Financial documents (obligation requests, disbursement vouchers, liquidation reports)

> **TIP:** Create this file structure at the start of implementation, not when the auditor arrives. If your CSW file is organized from Day 1, audit preparation takes hours instead of weeks.

Chapter Summary

- Budget request CSW must justify allocations with data, address utilization rates, and connect to BDP goals
- Project proposals must survive multiple approval layers by addressing each reviewer's priorities
- Personnel CSW is heavily regulated by CSC rules and BAA 17; documentation errors create personal liability
- Procurement CSW must follow RA 9184, include market surveys, and avoid restrictive specifications
- All MOA CSW flows through defined approval hierarchies with proper transmittal procedures
- COA compliance starts with the CSW — build audit-ready documentation from Day 1

Next: Chapter 13 covers writing standards and quality assurance — the discipline that ensures your CSW meets the professional standard.

Back to Table of Contents

13

Writing Standards and Quality Assurance

Your analysis can be brilliant. Your research can be thorough. Your recommendation can be optimal. But if the writing is unclear, the document is incomplete, or the review process is skipped, the CSW fails at the last mile.

This chapter establishes the writing standards and quality assurance practices that separate professional CSW from amateur paperwork.

13.1 The BARMM Guidebook Voice

CSW in the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region should have a consistent voice: **professional, direct, evidence-based, and accessible.**

Voice Characteristics

Characteristic	What It Means	Example
Professional	Formal but not stilted. No slang. No bureaucratic jargon without explanation.	Write "the agency's utilization rate decreased" not "the utilization rate went down bad"
Direct	State conclusions clearly. Use active voice.	Write "This report recommends Option B" not "Option B is being recommended by this report"
Evidence-based	Every claim cites a source. Opinions are identified as such.	Write "The dropout rate is 35% (MBHTE, 2025)" not "The dropout rate is high"
Accessible	A reader unfamiliar with the topic can understand the document.	Define technical terms on first use. Avoid acronyms without expansion.

Sentence and Paragraph Standards

- **Average sentence length:** 15-20 words. Maximum 30 words per sentence.
- **Maximum paragraph length:** 5 sentences. One-sentence paragraphs are acceptable for emphasis.
- **Voice:** 80%+ active voice. Use passive only when the actor is unknown or irrelevant.

- **Mood:** Imperative for instructions ("Submit the report by Friday"). Indicative for analysis ("The data shows a declining trend").

Prohibited Phrases

The following phrases add bulk without adding meaning. Replace them.

Prohibited Phrase	Replacement
"It is important to note that"	(Delete — just state the note)
"In order to"	"To"
"It should be noted"	(Delete — just state it)
"With regard to"	"About" or "On"
"In the context of"	"In" or "For"
"As previously mentioned"	(Delete — or cite the section)
"For the purposes of"	"For"
"In light of the foregoing"	"Given this" or "Therefore"
"The aforementioned"	Name the thing again
"It is recommended that"	"This report recommends"
"Pursuant to the provisions of"	"Under"
"Notwithstanding the foregoing"	"Despite this" or "However"

> **TIP:** Read your CSW aloud. If a sentence makes you pause to figure out its meaning, re-write it. If a paragraph forces you to re-read, split it or simplify the structure.

13.2 Clarity, Completeness, Conciseness, Objectivity

Every CSW output is evaluated against four quality dimensions.

Clarity

Test: Can a reader understand your document on the first reading?

Clarity Problem	Fix
Ambiguous pronoun references	Replace “it” and “they” with specific nouns
Long, multi-clause sentences	Break into two sentences
Undefined acronyms	Spell out on first use, then use the acronym
Vague quantities (“several,” “many,” “some”)	Replace with specific numbers
Abstract language	Use concrete examples

Completeness

Test: Does the document contain every section required by its CSW type template?

- ☐ All required sections are present and filled (no placeholders)
- ☐ Data covers the full scope of the analysis (not just convenient data)
- ☐ All options in the evaluation matrix have been scored on all criteria
- ☐ The implementation plan includes timeline, resources, and responsibilities
- ☐ The Executive Summary covers problem, recommendation, benefits, and action requested
- ☐ Legal citations are complete (Article, Section, full BAA number)

Conciseness

Test: Can any sentence be removed without losing meaning?

- Delete filler phrases (see prohibited phrases above)
- Eliminate redundancy (“completely finished” becomes “finished”)

- Remove hedging language ("it might perhaps be possible to consider" becomes "consider")
- Use tables instead of paragraphs when presenting comparative data
- Aim for the shortest document that is still complete

Objectivity

Test: Would someone who disagrees with your recommendation still find the analysis fair?

- Present all sides of an argument before stating your position
- Distinguish facts from opinions
- Report unfavorable findings as transparently as favorable ones
- Avoid advocacy language in the analysis sections (save it for the recommendation)
- Identify and disclose your assumptions

> **CAUTION:** The most common objectivity failure in BARMM CSW is advocacy disguised as analysis. If you have a preferred outcome, you may unconsciously downplay evidence against it. Guard against this by asking a peer to read your options analysis and check for bias.

13.3 The "So What" Test

Every section of your CSW must answer: "So what?" If the reader can ask "so what?" and your document has no answer, the section is missing its purpose.

Applying the "So What" Test

Section	Data/Finding	"So What?"	Actionable Interpretation
Budget comparison	"The agency's MOOE increased by 23% from FY 2025 to FY 2026"	So what?	"The 23% MOOE increase is driven by a PHP 45M addition for the new scholarship program, which aligns with BDP Goal 2. The committee should verify whether the program design justifies this scale of investment."
Research findings	"42% of daycare centers lack qualified teachers"	So what?	"This 42% gap means 62,000 children receive substandard early learning, placing BARMM at risk of non-compliance with RA 12199 by June 2026"
Stakeholder analysis	"The LGU Mayors' League expressed concerns about fiscal capacity"	So what?	"LGU fiscal constraints mean the national government or BARMM block grant must cover the salary supplement cost. A local cost-sharing model is not feasible."

Every data point should connect to a consequence, a decision, or a next step. Data without interpretation is noise.

13.4 Peer Review Process

No CSW should be submitted without at least one peer review.

Peer Review Protocol

Step	Action	Timeframe
1	Author completes self-review using the QA checklist (Appendix F)	Before sharing
2	Author sends draft to a peer reviewer (different person from the author)	Allow 1-2 working days
3	Peer reviewer reads the entire document and provides written comments	Written feedback, not verbal
4	Author reviews feedback and incorporates valid points	Same day or next day
5	Author and reviewer discuss any disagreements	Brief meeting
6	Author submits revised draft to supervisor	After incorporating feedback

What Peer Reviewers Should Check

Category	Questions
Logic	Does the recommendation follow from the analysis? Are there logical gaps?
Data	Are the numbers correct? Are sources cited? Are there data inconsistencies?
Completeness	Are any required sections missing or incomplete?
Clarity	Is the document understandable on first reading? Are there confusing passages?
Formatting	Does the document follow the template? Are tables, headings, and citations consistent?
Sensitivity	

Category	Questions
	Are there political, cultural, or security sensitivities the author may have missed?

> **TIP:** Choose a peer reviewer who knows the subject well enough to challenge your analysis, but is not so close to the project that they share your blind spots. The best reviewer is someone in a related but different role.

13.5 Shari'ah and Gender Review

BARMM CSW has two additional quality dimensions that most Philippine government CSW does not: Shari'ah alignment and gender responsiveness.

Shari'ah Review

When required: Any CSW that touches family law, personal status, halal industry, Islamic finance, waqf (endowment), zakat (obligatory charity), education with Islamic content, or any matter within the Shari'ah justice system's jurisdiction.

What to check:

Element	Question
BOL Article X compliance	Does the recommendation align with the BOL's provisions on Shari'ah?
Consistency with Islamic principles	Does the proposed action conflict with established Islamic jurisprudential positions?
Dar al-Ifta consultation	For matters requiring fatwas or religious opinions, has the Dar al-Ifta been consulted?
Language and framing	Is the document respectful of Islamic terminology and concepts?

Not every CSW requires Shari'ah review. But when the subject matter intersects with Islamic governance, law, or values, do not skip it.

Gender Review

When required: All CSW should be reviewed for gender responsiveness, but it is especially critical for CSW involving social services, education, health, economic programs, personnel policies, and budgeting.

What to check:

Element	Question
Sex-disaggregated data	Does the research present data broken down by sex where relevant?
Gender-differentiated impact	Does the impact analysis assess effects on women, men, and gender-diverse persons separately?
GAD compliance	Does the recommendation align with the Philippine Commission on Women (PCW) framework, adapted for BARMM?
GAD budget allocation	For budget proposals, is the minimum GAD allocation reflected?
Inclusive language	Does the document use gender-inclusive language?

> **BANGSAMORO NOTE:** Gender review in BARMM must navigate the intersection of Islamic values and national GAD frameworks. This requires sensitivity and expertise. When in doubt, consult with both the Bangsamoro Women Commission and relevant Islamic scholars to ensure your CSW respects both frameworks.

13.6 The Transmittal Memorandum as Quality Gate

The transmittal memorandum (Chapter 8, Section 8.11) is more than a routing document. It is a quality gate.

When your supervisor signs the transmittal memo, they certify three things:

1. **Accuracy** — The facts in the CSW are correct to the best of their knowledge
2. **Completeness** — All required sections are filled and all necessary analysis has been conducted
3. **Quality** — The CSW meets professional standards and is decision-ready

Quality Gate Checklist (Before Supervisor Signature)

The supervisor should verify before signing:

- ☐ Executive Summary is present and accurate
- ☐ Problem statement is specific and measurable
- ☐ Research findings are cited with sources
- ☐ At least 2-3 options were genuinely evaluated
- ☐ Recommendation is justified with evidence
- ☐ Implementation plan is actionable
- ☐ Call to action is clear and specific
- ☐ Legal citations are accurate (BOL, BAAs, national laws)
- ☐ Names and titles of officials are correct
- ☐ No grammatical errors or typos
- ☐ Template format is followed
- ☐ Shari'ah review completed (if applicable)
- ☐ Gender review completed (if applicable)

If any item fails, the CSW goes back for revision. The supervisor should not sign an incomplete or substandard transmittal.

> **TIP:** Build a culture where returning CSW for revision is normal, not punitive. Quality revision is a learning opportunity. The supervisor's feedback sharpens the analyst's skills. The analyst who never gets feedback never improves.

Chapter Summary

- Use the BARMM guidebook voice: professional, direct, evidence-based, accessible
- Maintain sentence and paragraph length standards. Eliminate prohibited phrases.
- Evaluate every CSW against four dimensions: clarity, completeness, conciseness, objectivity
- Apply the "So What" test to every data point and finding
- Conduct mandatory peer review before supervisor submission
- Complete Shari'ah review (where applicable) and gender review (for all CSW)
- Treat the transmittal memorandum as a quality gate — the supervisor's signature certifies accuracy, completeness, and quality

Next: Chapter 14 addresses the institutional dimension — how to build a CSW culture that sustains quality beyond individual outputs.

Back to Table of Contents

14

Building a CSW Culture

A single training session does not create a CSW culture. A well-written guidebook does not either. Culture is built through leadership, systems, incentives, and sustained practice. This chapter addresses what happens after the training ends and the guidebook goes on the shelf.

If you are a supervisor, director, or head of entity, this chapter is for you. You determine whether CSW becomes institutional practice or remains a one-time exercise.

14.1 The 12 ACSCCRaPATFEE Competencies

The **ACSCCRaPATFEE** framework defines 12 competencies that a CSW practitioner needs to master. Each competency maps to specific ADDRESS IT steps.

#	Competency	Code	Primary ADDRESS IT Steps
1	Analytical and Critical Thinking	**A**	Step 1 (Analyze), Step 3 (Research)
2	Creativity and Innovation	**C**	Step 4 (Explore Options)
3	Strategic Thinking	**S**	Step 1 (Analyze), Step 4 (Explore), Step 7 (Iterate)
4	Communication	**C**	Step 5 (Submit), Step 6 (Sustain)
5	Collaboration and Teamwork	**C**	Step 2 (Deliberate), Step 6 (Sustain)
6	Research and Analysis	**Ra**	Step 3 (Research)
7	Problem-Solving and Decision Making	**P**	Step 2 (Define), Step 4 (Explore)
8	Attention to Details and Quality	**A**	Step 5 (Submit), Quality Pipeline
9	Time and Attention Management	**T**	All steps (cross-cutting)
10	Flexibility and Adaptability	**F**	Step 7 (Iterate), Step 6 (Sustain)
11	Emotional Intelligence and Accountability	**E**	Step 2 (Deliberate), Step 6 (Sustain)
12	Ethics and Integrity	**E**	All steps (cross-cutting)

Assessment Levels

Each competency is assessed on a 7-level scale:

Level	Label	Description
1	**Novice**	Needs extensive guidance; struggles with basic concepts
2	**Beginner**	General understanding of basics; can complete simple tasks with support
3	**Emerging**	Independently handles routine tasks
4	**Intermediate**	Reliable grasp; independently manages most tasks
5	**Proficient**	Strong understanding; navigates complex tasks; shares knowledge
6	**Advanced**	Deep understanding; develops creative solutions; leads others
7	**Expert**	Leading authority; pioneers innovative approaches

Appendix J contains the full ACSCCRaPATFEE Competency Assessment Tool with 42 statements across all 12 competencies. Use it for pre-training baseline measurement, post-training evaluation, and ongoing professional development.

Using the Competency Framework

For supervisors: Assess your team against the 12 competencies. Identify which competencies are strong and which need development. Focus training investments on the weakest areas.

For training designers: Map training sessions to specific competencies. Ensure every competency is addressed at least once in the training program. Use the assessment tool for pre/post measurement.

For individual staff: Self-assess annually. Identify your top 3 strengths and top 3 development areas. Create a personal development plan with specific actions for improvement.

14.2 Training Staff in ADDRESS IT

Training Design Principles

A CSW training program built on ADDRESS IT follows a three-day structure:

Day	Focus	Activities
Day 1	Foundations	CSW philosophy, legal basis, ACSCCRaPATFEE self-assessment, ADDRESS IT Steps 1-3
Day 2	Process and Practice	ADDRESS IT Steps 4-7, CSW output types and templates, writeshop preparation
Day 3	Writeshop and Presentation	Draft a real CSW output, peer review, team presentations, action planning

Training Best Practices

1. **Use real problems.** Participants should work on actual assignments from their offices, not hypothetical scenarios. The writeshop output should be something they can use after training.
2. **Mix experience levels.** Pair new staff with experienced practitioners. The experienced staff reinforce their knowledge by teaching. The new staff learn from practice, not just theory.
3. **Include supervisors.** If supervisors do not attend training, they cannot enforce CSW standards. Include at least one session specifically for supervisors on how to review and provide feedback on CSW.
4. **Follow up.** Training without follow-up produces no lasting change. Schedule check-ins at 30, 60, and 90 days. Ask participants to submit the CSW output they started during the writeshop.
5. **Measure impact.** Use the ACSCCRaPATFEE assessment tool before and after training. Compare scores. Calculate competency gains. Report results to entity leadership.

Training Adaptation by Entity Type

Entity	Key Adaptations
Parliament	Emphasize legislative briefers, committee reports, oversight CSW. Use BAA and bill examples.
MOAs	Emphasize policy memos, project proposals, budget requests. Use ministry-specific cases.
LGUs	Emphasize local governance challenges. Use MC 2/2022 as primary legal basis. Simpler output formats.
Mixed audience	Use the General CSW (GN) template. Form cross-entity teams for knowledge exchange.

14.3 Institutionalizing CSW Practices

Training creates knowledge. Institutionalization creates habits.

Institutionalization Mechanisms

Mechanism	How It Works	Who Implements
Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)	Write CSW into your office's official processes. Define when CSW is required, what format to use, and who reviews it.	Division chiefs, heads of office
Templates library	Maintain a shared folder of approved CSW templates (GN, BB, LA, PP, LO, PA, SV). Update templates annually.	Knowledge management officer
Quality review system	Establish a peer review requirement for all CSW before transmittal. Assign review pairs.	Supervisor
Recognition program	Acknowledge excellent CSW outputs publicly. Feature best examples in internal communications.	Head of entity
Mentoring program	Pair new staff with experienced CSW practitioners for their first three months.	HR, supervisor
Annual CSW audit	Review a sample of CSW outputs annually. Assess quality trends. Identify systemic issues.	Planning or quality office

Embedding CSW in Daily Workflows

CSW becomes culture when staff do not think of it as a separate activity. Embed it into existing workflows:

- **Before any decision memo goes to the head of office**, require ADDRESS IT Step 1-5 documentation
- **During weekly team meetings**, include a 5-minute CSW status update
- **In performance evaluations**, include CSW quality as an assessment criterion
- **In job descriptions**, include "produces complete staff work following ADDRESS IT methodology"

14.4 Continuous Improvement as Organizational Habit

CSW quality should improve over time. Track it.

Quality Metrics

Metric	How to Measure	Target
First-pass approval rate	Percentage of CSW outputs approved without revision	70%+
Average revision cycles	Number of times CSW is returned before approval	1.5 or fewer
Template compliance	Percentage of CSW outputs using approved templates	90%+
Timeliness	Percentage of CSW outputs submitted by deadline	85%+
Decision-maker satisfaction	Brief quarterly survey of decision-makers	4.0/5.0+
COA findings reduction	Number of audit observations related to documentation gaps	Year-over-year decrease

Continuous Improvement Cycle

1. **Measure** — Collect quality metrics quarterly
2. **Analyze** — Identify patterns (which templates cause problems? which steps are consistently weak?)
3. **Improve** — Update templates, provide targeted training, adjust SOPs
4. **Share** — Publish quality reports to the team. Celebrate improvement. Address persistent gaps.

Learning from CSW Failures

When a CSW output fails — returned by the decision-maker, challenged by COA, or producing poor implementation results — conduct a brief failure analysis:

Question	Purpose
Which ADDRESS IT step failed?	Identifies where the process broke down
Which competency was weak?	Identifies what training or mentoring is needed
Was it a systemic issue or an individual issue?	Determines whether the fix is organizational or personal
What should change to prevent recurrence?	Produces an actionable improvement

Document the lesson and share it (anonymized) with the team. Failure analysis is not blame. It is organizational learning.

14.5 The Supervisor's Role in CSW Quality

Supervisors make or break CSW culture. Their behavior determines whether staff produce quality work or cut corners.

What Effective CSW Supervisors Do

Practice	Impact
Read every CSW output before signing	Staff know their work will be scrutinized; quality rises
Provide specific, written feedback	Staff learn from mistakes; competencies develop
Return incomplete work without exception	The "completed" standard becomes real, not aspirational
Acknowledge excellent work	Staff are motivated to maintain high standards
Give clear assignments	Staff understand what is expected; Step 1 is easier
Set realistic deadlines	Staff have time to do thorough research and analysis
Model CSW in their own work	Staff follow the example they see, not just the rules they hear

What Ineffective CSW Supervisors Do

Anti-pattern	Consequence
Sign without reading	Staff learn that quality does not matter; standards collapse
Provide only verbal, vague feedback	Staff cannot learn from mistakes; same errors repeat
Accept incomplete work under time pressure	The "completed" standard erodes; "good enough" becomes the norm
Rewrite staff work themselves	Staff never learn; supervisor becomes bottleneck
Give vague assignments	Staff waste time guessing; outputs miss the mark

Anti-pattern	Consequence
Set impossible deadlines	Staff skip research and option analysis; quality suffers

> **TIP:** The single most powerful thing a supervisor can do for CSW quality is to **return incomplete work consistently.** When staff know that cutting corners means the document comes back, they stop cutting corners. When they know the supervisor will not check, they stop trying.

The Supervisor as CSW Coach

Beyond reviewing outputs, supervisors should actively develop their staff's CSW capabilities:

1. **Debrief after every major CSW output.** What went well? What was difficult? What would you do differently?
2. **Assign progressively complex CSW.** Start new staff with General CSW (GN). Move to specialized types (BB, LA, PP) as competence grows.
3. **Pair junior and senior staff.** Joint assignments allow coaching during the actual work, not just in training rooms.
4. **Recommend staff for training.** When you identify a competency gap, recommend targeted training rather than waiting for the next general session.
5. **Celebrate improvement.** When a staff member's CSW quality visibly improves, acknowledge it publicly. Recognition reinforces the behavior you want to see.

Chapter Summary

- The ACSCCRaPATFEE framework defines 12 CSW competencies mapped to ADDRESS IT steps, assessed on a 7-level scale
- CSW training follows a 3-day structure: foundations, process and practice, writeshop and presentation
- Institutionalization requires SOPs, template libraries, quality review systems, recognition programs, and mentoring
- Embed CSW in daily workflows, job descriptions, and performance evaluations — not as a separate activity

- Track quality metrics: first-pass approval rate, revision cycles, template compliance, timeliness, and decision-maker satisfaction
- Learn from failures through structured analysis
- Supervisors determine CSW culture through consistent quality enforcement, specific feedback, and coaching

---

This concludes the 14 chapters of the Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region. Use the Glossary for term definitions and the Appendices for templates, checklists, reference cards, and sample documents.

Back to Table of Contents

Glossary

This glossary defines key terms used throughout the Complete Staff Work Guidebook for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region.

ACSCCRaPATFEE — The 12-competency framework for CSW practitioners: Analytical and Critical Thinking, Creativity and Innovation, Strategic Thinking, Communication, Collaboration and Teamwork, Research and Analysis, Problem-Solving and Decision Making, Attention to Details and Quality, Time and Attention Management, Flexibility and Adaptability, Emotional Intelligence and Accountability, Ethics and Integrity. Developed by the author as a companion to the ADDRESS IT methodology.

ADDRESS IT — The seven-step Complete Staff Work methodology: **A**nalyze the Context, **D**efine and **D**eliberate the Problem or Need, **R**esearch Needed Information, **E**xplore Options, **S**ubmit Proposal or Report, **S**ustain Efforts to Implement, **I**terate and **I**mprove. The mnemonic framework structures CSW from analysis through implementation and continuous improvement.

Approval Chain — The hierarchical sequence of reviewers and endorsers a CSW output must pass through before reaching the final decision-maker. Typically: analyst, section head, division chief, director, minister (or equivalent).

BAA (Bangsamoro Autonomy Act) — Legislation enacted by the Bangsamoro Parliament. BAAs are the laws of the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region. Referenced in CSW for legal basis and compliance requirements.

BDP (Bangsamoro Development Plan) — The master planning document for BARMM. The BDP 2023-2028 articulates six development goals, eight core strategies, and specific targets. CSW outputs should demonstrate alignment with BDP priorities.

BEP (Bangsamoro Expenditure Program) — The annual budget document submitted by the Bangsamoro Government to Parliament for appropriation. The BEP details budget allocations by agency, program, and expenditure class.

BOL (Bangsamoro Organic Law) — Republic Act No. 11054, the foundational law establishing the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao. The supreme law of BARMM, against which all CSW recommendations must be checked for consistency.

BTA (Bangsamoro Transitional Authority) — The interim government of BARMM, serving until the first regular elections. The BTA exercises both legislative (Parliament) and executive (Chief Minister and MOAs) functions.

Budget Briefer (BB) — A 13-section CSW output (BB01-BB13) used to analyze an agency's budget during Parliament's appropriation process. Covers agency mandate, development goals, organizational outcomes, budget comparison, PPAS analysis, and recommendations.

Call to Action — The concluding section of a CSW output that states exactly what the decision-maker is asked to approve or decide. Must be specific and actionable.

Capital Outlay (CO) — Budget category for acquisition of assets: land, buildings, equipment, infrastructure, and other fixed assets with useful life beyond one year.

CBA (Cost-Benefit Analysis) — A systematic method for comparing the total costs and total benefits of each option. Used in ADDRESS IT Step 4 (Explore Options) to assess value and return on investment.

COA (Commission on Audit) — The constitutional body that examines, audits, and settles all government accounts. CSW outputs must anticipate COA requirements and build audit-ready documentation.

Complete Staff Work (CSW) — A study of a problem that includes a recommended action by staff personnel, carried to the point where all that remains for the head of office is to approve or disapprove. The professional standard mandated by MC 72/2019 and MC 2/2022.

CSW Type — One of nine categories of CSW output: Legislative Analysis Briefer (LA), Budget Briefer (BB), Policy Recommendation (PR), Legal Opinion (LO), Project Proposal (PP), Personnel/Administrative Action (PA), Supervision System (SV), General CSW (GN), or Custom CSW (CU).

Decision-Maker — The individual with authority to approve or disapprove the CSW recommendation. May be a committee chairperson, minister, director, or head of office, depending on the institutional context.

Evaluation Criteria — The five standards against which CSW options are assessed: Feasibility, Effectiveness, Efficiency, Sustainability, and Alignment with organizational goals.

Executive Summary — A one-page overview of a CSW output capturing the problem, recommended solution, expected benefits, and action requested. Always written last, after all other sections are complete.

Fishbone Diagram (Ishikawa Diagram) — A root cause analysis tool that organizes potential causes of a problem into categories (People, Process, Policy, Resources, Environment, Data). Used in ADDRESS IT Step 2 (Define and Deliberate).

Five Whys (5 Whys) — A root cause analysis technique that asks "Why?" iteratively (typically five times) to trace a problem from its surface symptoms to its root cause. Used in ADDRESS IT Step 2.

GAAB (General Appropriations Act of the Bangsamoro) — The enacted budget law for a given fiscal year. The BEP becomes the GAAB after Parliament approval.

GAD (Gender and Development) — A cross-cutting framework requiring government programs and budgets to address gender-specific needs. CSW outputs should include gender analysis where applicable.

General CSW (GN) — The universal CSW template (9 sections, GN01-GN09) for issues that do not fit a specialized type. Follows the ADDRESS IT framework directly as its section structure.

Implementation Plan — The section of a CSW output that specifies actions, timelines, responsible parties, resource requirements, risks, and monitoring indicators for carrying out the approved recommendation.

KPI (Key Performance Indicator) — A measurable value that demonstrates how effectively an implementation is achieving its objectives. Defined during ADDRESS IT Step 6 (Sustain) and tracked during Step 7 (Iterate).

Legislative Analysis Briefer (LA) — A 13-section CSW output used by Parliament staff to analyze bills, resolutions, or policy issues for committee deliberation.

MC 2/2022 (Memorandum Circular No. 2, Series of 2022) — Civil Service Commission circular extending the CSW requirement to local government units.

MC 72/2019 (Memorandum Circular No. 72, Series of 2019) — Civil Service Commission circular establishing Complete Staff Work as a standard for national government agencies.

MOA (Ministry, Office, or Agency) — The executive branch entities of BARMM, including Ministries (e.g., MFBM, MBHTE), Offices (e.g., OCM), and Agencies. MOA staff produce CSW for executive decision-making.

MOOE (Maintenance and Other Operating Expenses) — Budget category for day-to-day operating costs: supplies, travel, utilities, communications, training, and contracted services.

Moral Governance — A foundational principle of Bangsamoro governance emphasizing ethical decision-making, accountability, transparency, and public trust. Established in BAA 13 and grounded in Islamic governance values.

Options Evaluation Matrix — A structured tool for scoring and ranking CSW options against the five evaluation criteria using weighted scores. Used in ADDRESS IT Step 4.

Peer Review — A quality assurance step where a colleague reviews the CSW output before it is submitted to the supervisor. Checks for logic, data accuracy, completeness, clarity, and sensitivity.

PESTEL Analysis — A framework for examining external factors: Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Environmental, and Legal. Used in ADDRESS IT Step 1 (Analyze the Context) to scan the environment surrounding a CSW issue.

PPAS (Programs, Projects, Activities, and Services) — The specific activities funded by an agency's budget, classified as Tier 1 (existing) or Tier 2 (new proposals).

PRLS (Parliamentary Rules and Legislative Staff) — The administrative support structure for parliamentary proceedings and legislative staff work.

Problem Statement — A clear, specific, measurable articulation of the problem or need that the CSW addresses. Includes the gap between current and desired states, consequences of inaction, and institutional alignment. Produced during ADDRESS IT Step 2.

PS (Personnel Services) — Budget category for salaries, wages, allowances, and benefits of government personnel.

RA 9184 (Government Procurement Reform Act) — The national law governing procurement of goods, infrastructure, and consulting services by government agencies, including BARMM entities.

Root Cause Analysis — The process of identifying the underlying factors that produce a problem, distinguishing root causes from surface symptoms. Techniques include the 5 Whys and fishbone diagram.

SMART Objectives — Objectives that are Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound. Set during ADDRESS IT Step 2 to define what the CSW effort aims to accomplish.

Stakeholder Analysis — A systematic identification and assessment of individuals, groups, or institutions affected by or interested in the CSW issue. Categorizes stakeholders by interest, influence, and position.

Stoplight Format — A progress reporting method using color codes: Green (on track, 90%+ of target), Yellow (at risk, 70-89%), Red (off track, below 70%).

Transmittal Memorandum — The cover memo accompanying a CSW output to the decision-maker. Introduces the document, summarizes the recommendation, states the action requested, and carries the supervisor's endorsement signature. Serves as a quality gate.

Back to Table of Contents